

The Great Works Course: Essentials (~251 hours)

From the Essential Reading List. Tick the boxes as you go; links open in your browser.

A 250-hour track through the same reading list. Thirteen modules of roughly 12 to 25 hours each. In each module you read short, specific passages from the key works. You then survey the module's other works by reading their descriptions, about a minute each, so every one of the 571 entries is covered at least at the level of its main idea. Hour figures are rough estimates for the assigned passages.

Assigned passages: about 243 hours. Survey of the remaining works: about 7.7 hours.

Contents

1. Module 1: How to Read and Argue (~12 h)
2. Module 2: Homer and the Gods (~17.1 h)
3. Module 3: Tragedy, History, and the City (~18.7 h)
4. Module 4: Plato and Aristotle (~19.6 h)
5. Module 5: Rome: Duty, Empire, and the Stoics (~21 h)
6. Module 6: The Bible (~21.7 h)
7. Module 7: Augustine and Late Antiquity (~15.5 h)
8. Module 8: The Medieval World (~23.6 h)
9. Module 9: Judaism and Islam (~17.9 h)
10. Module 10: India, China, and Japan (~21.6 h)
11. Module 11: Renaissance and the New Science (~21.3 h)
12. Module 12: The Modern Mind (~20.9 h)
13. Module 13: The Modern Imagination (~19.8 h)

Module 1: How to Read and Argue

About 11.5 hours of reading and 0.5 hours of survey.

The classical tools for reading and arguing: definition, the syllogism, the common fallacies, the parts of a speech, and the geometric proof. These are enough to follow the arguments in every later module.

What to take away

- Classification comes before argument. Genus, species, and difference are the basis of a definition.
- A syllogism is valid because of its form, whatever its content. Fallacies are arguments that only look valid.
- Rhetoric has five parts: invention, arrangement, style, memory, and delivery. Euclid's method of building from axioms became the model of certain knowledge.

Read

1. ☐ **Porphyry — Isagoge** (~2 h)

Read: The whole text; it is short. Learn the five predicables.

Edition: Tr. Jonathan Barnes, *Porphyry: Introduction* (Oxford Clarendon Later Ancient Philosophers)

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2. ☐ **Aristotle — Categories** (~2 h)

Read: Chapters 1-5, ending with the account of substance.

Edition: Tr. J.L. Ackrill, *Categories and De Interpretatione* (Oxford Clarendon Aristotle Series); also in *The Complete Works of Aristotle*, ed. Barnes (Princeton)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [ToposText](#)

3. ☐ **Aristotle — the rest of the Organon (On Interpretation, Prior and Posterior Analytics, Topics, Sophistical Refutations)** (~3 h)

Read: Prior Analytics I.1-7 (the syllogism) and Sophistical Refutations 4-5 (the thirteen fallacies).

Edition: *The Complete Works of Aristotle*, ed. Jonathan Barnes, vol. 1 (Princeton); Prior Analytics tr. Robin Smith (Hackett)

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4. ☐ **Anon. (Pseudo-Cicero) — Rhetorica ad Herennium** (~2 h)

Read: Book I.2-4 (the five canons and the parts of a speech) and Book III.16-24 (the art of memory).

Edition: Tr. Harry Caplan (Loeb Classical Library 403)

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5. ☐ **Euclid — Elements** (~2.5 h)

Read: Book I: definitions, postulates, common notions, then propositions 1-5 and 47 (the Pythagorean theorem).

Edition: Tr. T.L. Heath, *The Thirteen Books of the Elements* (Dover); Green Lion Press one-volume edition

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Check yourself. Take one argument you have heard this week. Put it in syllogistic form and name any fallacy it commits.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Cicero — On Invention (De Inventione)**: An early, incomplete treatise by Cicero on rhetorical invention, the process of finding arguments for a speech. Written in his youth, it draws on earlier Greek rhetorical theory. It was widely studied as a rhetorical handbook in medieval Europe.
- ☐ **Priscian — Institutes of Grammar (Institutiones Grammaticae)**: A comprehensive Latin grammar composed in the early sixth century AD by the grammarian Priscian of Caesarea. It systematically covers Latin morphology and syntax. It served as a standard grammatical authority throughout the medieval period.
- ☐ **Servius the Grammarian — Commentary on Virgil**: A line-by-line commentary on Virgil's works, especially the Aeneid, written by the late fourth-century grammarian Servius. It provides historical, mythological, and linguistic notes and preserves information about Roman antiquity not found elsewhere.
- ☐ **St. Isidore — Etymologies (Etymologiae)**: A twenty-book encyclopedia compiled by Isidore of Seville in the early seventh century, organizing knowledge by the etymology of words. It covers subjects including grammar, law, medicine, and natural history, drawing on earlier classical sources. It was widely copied and used as a reference work throughout the Middle Ages.
- ☐ **Alcuin of York — Disputatio with Pippin**: A short Latin dialogue in question-and-answer form, attributed to Alcuin, between a teacher and Pippin, son of Charlemagne. It presents definitions of common concepts through riddles and metaphors, such as defining winter as "the exile of summer." It was used as a pedagogical text in the Carolingian period.
- ☐ **Donatus — Ars Minor; Ars Maior**: Two Latin grammar textbooks written by the fourth-century grammarian Aelius Donatus. The Ars Minor covers the parts of speech in question-and-answer form for beginners, while the Ars Maior treats grammar and rhetorical figures in more depth. They were the standard introductory grammars of medieval Europe.
- ☐ **Boethius — On Topical Differences; the logical commentaries**: Sixth-century Latin works by Boethius, including translations of and commentaries on Aristotle's logical treatises and Porphyry's Isagoge. On Topical Differences catalogs types of argument, or topics, used in dialectic and rhetoric. These texts transmitted much of Greek logic to the Latin-speaking West before most of Aristotle's original works were available in Latin.
- ☐ **Cicero — De Oratore; Orator; Topica; Brutus**: A group of rhetorical works by Cicero examining the qualities and training of the ideal orator. De Oratore, written as a dialogue, argues that effective oratory requires broad general knowledge as well as technical skill. Brutus surveys the history of Roman oratory, and the Topica adapts Aristotelian topics for legal argument.
- ☐ **Quintilian — Institutio Oratoria**: A twelve-book treatise on rhetorical education by the first-century Roman teacher Quintilian. It outlines a curriculum for training an orator from childhood through mature practice, covering grammar, style, delivery, and ethical formation. It was rediscovered in complete form in 1416 and influenced Renaissance humanist education.
- ☐ **Martianus Capella — The Marriage of Philology and Mercury**: A fifth-century Latin allegorical work in prose and verse, in which the marriage of Mercury and the maiden Philology is attended by personifications of the seven liberal arts, each delivering a speech summarizing its content. The work established the sevenfold division of the liberal arts, the trivium and quadrivium, used throughout medieval education.

- ☐ **Longinus — On the Sublime:** A Greek treatise on literary style, of disputed authorship (traditionally attributed to "Longinus"), probably composed in the first century AD. It analyzes the sources of sublimity, or grandeur, in writing, including elevated thought, strong emotion, and figures of speech, illustrated with examples from Homer and other authors.
- ☐ **Dionysius Thrax — The Art of Grammar:** A short Greek grammatical treatise attributed to Dionysius Thrax, active in the second century BC, considered the earliest systematic grammar of Greek. It defines the parts of speech and basic grammatical categories and influenced later Greek and Latin grammatical writing.
- ☐ **Isocrates — Against the Sophists; Antidosis:** Prose works by the Athenian rhetorician Isocrates from the fourth century BC. *Against the Sophists* criticizes the teaching methods of rival rhetoric teachers and outlines his own approach; the *Antidosis* defends his career and educational philosophy, which combined rhetorical training with civic and ethical formation.
- ☐ **Hermogenes of Tarsus — On Types of Style:** A Greek rhetorical treatise, probably by the second-century rhetorician Hermogenes of Tarsus, analyzing qualities of prose style such as clarity, grandeur, and force, and how they are achieved through diction, word order, and figures. It became a standard textbook in Byzantine rhetorical education.
- ☐ **Bede — On the Art of Metre and On Figures of Speech:** Two short pedagogical works by the eighth-century Northumbrian monk Bede, treating Latin poetic meter and the rhetorical figures found in the Bible and classical texts. They were composed for use in monastic schools in Anglo-Saxon England.
- ☐ **St. Boethius — On Arithmetic; On Music:** Latin treatises by the sixth-century philosopher Boethius, adapting earlier Greek works, including that of Nicomachus of Gerasa, on number theory and musical theory. *On Music* discusses the mathematical ratios underlying musical intervals and distinguishes several categories of music, including music of the celestial spheres. The works served as standard textbooks for the medieval quadrivium.
- ☐ **St. Bede — On the Reckoning of Time (De Temporum Ratione):** An eighth-century treatise by the Northumbrian monk Bede on computus, the calculation of the date of Easter, and chronology, including the dating of years from the birth of Christ. It also discusses the physical nature of time and the structure of the calendar.
- ☐ **Pliny the Elder — Natural History:** A thirty-seven-book encyclopedia compiled by the Roman author Pliny the Elder in the first century AD, covering subjects including astronomy, geography, zoology, botany, and mineralogy. Pliny died in 79 AD during the eruption of Mount Vesuvius. The work was widely copied and consulted throughout the medieval period.
- ☐ **Alcuin of York — Problems to Sharpen the Young (Propositiones ad Acuendos Juvenes):** A collection of mathematical puzzles attributed to Alcuin of York, an eighth-century scholar at the court of Charlemagne. It includes problems such as river-crossing puzzles and questions about measuring quantities, and is considered among the earliest recreational mathematics texts in the Latin tradition.
- ☐ **Nicomachus of Gerasa — Introduction to Arithmetic:** A Greek treatise on number theory by Nicomachus, active around 100 AD, covering properties of numbers such as odd, even, prime, and figurate numbers within a Pythagorean framework. It was translated into Latin by Boethius and became a standard source for arithmetic in medieval education.
- ☐ **Ptolemy — Almagest; Harmonics:** The *Almagest*, composed by Claudius Ptolemy in the second century AD, presents a mathematical model of the geocentric universe and remained the standard astronomical reference until the Copernican revolution. His *Harmonics* addresses the mathematics of musical scales and intervals.

- ☐ **Macrobius — Commentary on the Dream of Scipio:** A Latin commentary written in the early fifth century by Macrobius on the concluding section of Cicero's *De Republica*. It expands on themes including the harmony of the celestial spheres, the nature of the soul, and cosmology, and was a major channel through which Neoplatonic ideas reached the medieval West.
- ☐ **Aratus — Phaenomena:** A Greek didactic poem composed in the third century BC by Aratus, describing the constellations and weather signs in verse. It was translated into Latin several times, including by Cicero, and a line from it is quoted in the Acts of the Apostles.
- ☐ **Hyginus — Poeticon Astronomicum:** A Latin work traditionally attributed to Hyginus, cataloging the mythological stories associated with each constellation. It served as a reference for classical star-myths in later periods.
- ☐ **Bede — On the Nature of Things (De Natura Rerum):** A short treatise by Bede describing the physical world, including the elements, weather phenomena, and the heavens, drawing on earlier sources such as Pliny and Isidore of Seville. It complements his later work on time-reckoning, *De Temporum Ratione*.
- ☐ **Archimedes — The Works:** The surviving treatises of the Greek mathematician Archimedes, active in the third century BC, covering topics including the law of buoyancy, the measurement of the circle, the areas and volumes of geometric solids, and, in the *Sand-Reckoner*, a system for expressing very large numbers. His method of exhaustion anticipated later techniques of integral calculus.
- ☐ **Vitruvius — On Architecture:** A Latin treatise on architecture and engineering by the Roman architect Vitruvius, written in the first century BC. It is the only complete work on architecture to survive from antiquity, covering building materials, construction methods, proportion, and machines, and includes a description of human bodily proportion later illustrated as "Vitruvian Man."
- ☐ **Apollonius of Perga — Conics:** A Greek mathematical treatise by Apollonius of Perga, active in the third century BC, on conic sections, defining and naming the ellipse, parabola, and hyperbola. Its results were later applied by Johannes Kepler in describing planetary orbits.
- ☐ **Diophantus — Arithmetica:** A Greek mathematical text by Diophantus of Alexandria, probably composed in the third century AD, addressing algebraic equations, particularly those seeking integer or rational solutions. A marginal note by Pierre de Fermat on a copy of this work states what became known as Fermat's Last Theorem.
- ☐ **Aristoxenus — Elements of Harmonics:** A Greek treatise on music theory by Aristoxenus, a student of Aristotle active in the fourth century BC. It analyzes musical scales and intervals based on the perception of trained hearing, in contrast to the purely numerical approach of earlier Pythagorean music theory.
- ☐ **Sacrobosco — On the Sphere (De Sphaera):** A thirteenth-century Latin astronomical textbook by Johannes de Sacrobosco, describing the spherical earth, the celestial spheres, and basic astronomical phenomena. It was a standard university text on astronomy in Europe for several centuries.

Module 2: Homer and the Gods

About 17 hours of reading and 0.1 hours of survey.

The Iliad and the Odyssey are the most frequently referenced works in the Western sections of the list. This module reads the books that carry each poem's plot and turning points, plus Hesiod's account of the gods and the earliest Greek lyric.

What to take away

- The Iliad is about the anger of Achilles, and about honor, mortality, and recognizing a shared humanity in an enemy (Priam and Achilles in Book 24).
- The Odyssey is about cunning, homecoming, and xenia, the obligations between guest and host.
- Hesiod gives the family tree of the gods and a moral picture of justice and labor.

Read

1. ☐ **Homer — The Iliad; The Odyssey** (~15 h)

Read: Iliad 1, 6, 9, 18, 22, 24. Odyssey 1, 9-12, 19, 21-23.

Edition: Iliad tr. Richmond Lattimore (Chicago) or Robert Fagles (Penguin); Odyssey tr. Lattimore (Harper) or Emily Wilson (Norton)

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2. ☐ **Hesiod — Theogony; Works and Days** (~1.5 h)

Read: Theogony 1-210 (creation and Kronos) and Works and Days 1-201 (Prometheus, Pandora, the five ages).

Edition: Tr. M.L. West, Theogony and Works and Days (Oxford World's Classics)

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3. ☐ **Sappho — Fragments** (~0.5 h)

Read: Fragments 1, 16, and 31.

Edition: Tr. Anne Carson, If Not, Winter (Vintage)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

Check yourself. What does Achilles learn between Book 9 and Book 24?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **The Homeric Hymns:** A collection of anonymous Greek hymns in epic style, addressed to various gods, composed between roughly the seventh and fourth centuries BC. They include narrative episodes such as the abduction of Persephone in the Hymn to Demeter and the infancy of Hermes.
- ☐ **Apollonius of Rhodes — Argonautica:** A Hellenistic Greek epic poem by Apollonius of Rhodes, composed in the third century BC, recounting Jason's quest for the Golden Fleece with the Argonauts and his relationship with the sorceress Medea. It is noted for its detailed portrayal of Medea's internal conflict and later influenced Roman epic, including Virgil's Aeneid.

- ☐ **Pindar — Odes:** Choral odes composed by the Greek poet Pindar in the fifth century BC, celebrating victors in athletic competitions including the Olympic and Pythian games. They combine praise of the victor with mythological narrative and reflections on human achievement and mortality.
- ☐ **Aesop — The Fables:** A collection of short prose fables traditionally attributed to Aesop, said to have lived in Greece in the sixth century BC, though the surviving collections were compiled and expanded by later authors. Each fable typically features animal characters and concludes with a moral lesson.
- ☐ **Theocritus — Idylls:** A collection of Greek poems by Theocritus, active in the third century BC, largely set in rural Sicily and featuring shepherds and herdsmen. The Idylls are considered the founding works of the pastoral poetry genre, later imitated by Virgil and other poets.
- ☐ **Callimachus — Hymns; Aetia:** Works by the Alexandrian poet and scholar Callimachus, third century BC. The Hymns are poems addressed to various gods in the epic tradition; the Aetia is a fragmentary elegiac poem exploring the origins of various customs, rituals, and place names. Callimachus favored short, highly polished poetic forms over long epic.
- ☐ **Menander — The Grouch; the comedies:** Plays by the Athenian playwright Menander, fourth-third centuries BC, the principal representative of Greek New Comedy, of which The Grouch (Dyskolos) survives complete. His comedies center on domestic situations, romantic misunderstandings, and stock character types, and influenced Roman comic playwrights such as Plautus and Terence.
- ☐ **The Greek Anthology:** A large collection of Greek epigrams and short poems by numerous authors, compiled and expanded over roughly a thousand years, from the classical period through the Byzantine era. Its poems address subjects including love, death, art, and everyday life.

Module 3: Tragedy, History, and the City

About 18.5 hours of reading and 0.2 hours of survey.

Athens in the fifth century BC produced tragedy, comedy, and history writing within a few decades. Read two tragedians, one comedy, and the founding passages of the two founding historians.

What to take away

- Tragedy stages conflicts that have no clean resolution: vengeance against justice, family against the law of the city.
- Herodotus explains events through custom and fortune. Thucydides explains them through power, fear, and interest.
- The Melian dialogue is the classic statement of 'the strong do what they can and the weak suffer what they must'.

Read

1. ☐ **Aeschylus — The Oresteia; Prometheus Bound** (~4 h)

Read: Agamemnon and The Eumenides, the first and last plays of the trilogy.

Edition: Tr. Richmond Lattimore, in The Complete Greek Tragedies (Chicago); or tr. Robert Fagles (Penguin)

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2. ☐ **Sophocles — The Theban Plays; Ajax** (~4 h)

Read: Oedipus the King and Antigone.

Edition: Tr. Robert Fagles, The Three Theban Plays (Penguin); or David Grene, Sophocles I (Chicago)

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3. ☐ **Euripides — The Tragedies** (~2 h)

Read: The Bacchae.

Edition: The Complete Greek Tragedies: Euripides, ed. Grene and Lattimore (Chicago)

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4. ☐ **Aristophanes — The Comedies** (~2 h)

Read: The Clouds, a comic portrait of Socrates.

Edition: Tr. Peter Meineck, Clouds (Hackett); or Alan Sommerstein, Lysistrata and Other Plays (Penguin)

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5. ☐ **Herodotus — The Histories** (~2.5 h)

Read: The preface and I.1-45 (Croesus and Solon); VII.201-239 (Thermopylae).

Edition: The Landmark Herodotus, ed. Robert Strassler, tr. Andrea Purvis (Anchor)

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6. ☐ **Thucydides — The Peloponnesian War** (~4 h)

Read: I.20-23 (method); II.35-54 (Funeral Oration and plague); III.82-83 (civil strife at Corcyra); V.84-116 (the Melian dialogue).

Edition: The Landmark Thucydides, ed. Robert Strassler, tr. Richard Crawley (Free Press)

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Check yourself. Compare Antigone and Creon with the Athenians and Melians. Who appeals to what law?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Suetonius — The Twelve Caesars:** A Latin biographical work by Gaius Suetonius Tranquillus, written in the early 2nd century AD, covering Julius Caesar and the first eleven Roman emperors through Domitian. It is organized thematically as well as chronologically, including anecdotes about the subjects' private conduct alongside political events. It is a major source for the personal lives of the early emperors.
- ☐ **Sallust — The Catiline War; The Jugurthine War:** Two Latin historical monographs by Gaius Sallustius Crispus, written in the mid-1st century BC. The Catiline War covers the conspiracy of Catiline in 63 BC; the Jugurthine War covers Rome's war against the Numidian king Jugurtha. Both combine narrative with moralizing analysis attributing Rome's political troubles to a decline in traditional discipline.
- ☐ **Julius Caesar — The Gallic War; The Civil War:** First-person military narratives authored by Julius Caesar, covering his campaigns in Gaul from 58 to 50 BC and the civil war against Pompey in 49-48 BC. Written in the third person, they combine campaign narrative with justification of Caesar's political and military conduct. They are read both as historical sources and as models of Latin prose style.
- ☐ **Polybius — The Histories:** A Greek historian of the 2nd century BC, brought to Rome as a hostage, who wrote an account of Rome's rise to dominance in the Mediterranean between roughly 264 and 146 BC. The work includes analysis of the Roman constitution and a theory of the cyclical rise and decline of governments. Only a portion of the original forty books survives complete.
- ☐ **Josephus — The Jewish War; Antiquities of the Jews:** Works by Flavius Josephus, a Jewish military commander who defected to Rome during the First Jewish-Roman War. The Jewish War recounts the revolt of 66-73 AD and the destruction of the Second Temple; Antiquities of the Jews is a broader history of the Jewish people from creation to Josephus's own time. His writings are a major source for first-century Judea, including references to early Christianity.
- ☐ **Ammianus Marcellinus — The Later Roman Empire:** A Latin history, the Res Gestae, composed in the late 4th century AD by Ammianus Marcellinus, a former soldier, originally covering Roman history from 96 to 378 AD, of which the surviving portion covers 353-378. It includes an account of the reign of the emperor Julian, whom Ammianus had served. It is a principal narrative source for the later Roman Empire.
- ☐ **Arrian — The Anabasis of Alexander:** A Greek history of Alexander the Great's campaigns, written in the 2nd century AD by Arrian, a Roman provincial governor, based largely on the now-lost accounts of Alexander's officers Ptolemy and Aristobulus. It covers Alexander's campaigns from his accession through his death in 323 BC. It is generally regarded by historians as among the more reliable surviving accounts of Alexander's career.
- ☐ **Quintus Curtius Rufus — History of Alexander:** A Latin history of Alexander the Great, probably written in the 1st century AD, portions of which are lost. It presents a more rhetorical and moralizing account than Arrian's, with attention to the effects of success and power on Alexander's character. Its precise date and the identity of its author remain uncertain.

- ☐ **Diodorus Siculus — Bibliotheca Historica:** A universal history in Greek by Diodorus Siculus, written in the 1st century BC, covering mythological and historical events from the earliest times to Diodorus's own era across forty books, of which roughly a third survives intact. It draws on numerous earlier historians, some of whose works are otherwise lost. It is a significant secondary source for ancient historiography.
- ☐ **Strabo — Geography:** A seventeen-book Greek geographical work by Strabo, completed in the early 1st century AD, describing the physical geography, peoples, and customs of regions known to the Greco-Roman world. It combines firsthand travel observation with material drawn from earlier geographic and historical writers. It is a major source for ancient geography and ethnography.
- ☐ **Pausanias — Description of Greece:** A Greek work by Pausanias, written in the 2nd century AD, describing the topography, monuments, and traditions of mainland Greece region by region. It served travelers as a guide to sites of religious and historical significance. It is an important source for the identification and study of ancient Greek art and architecture.
- ☐ **Xenophon — Anabasis (The Persian Expedition):** A Greek prose narrative by Xenophon, an Athenian soldier and writer, describing the expedition of Greek mercenaries, the "Ten Thousand," hired by Cyrus the Younger in his bid for the Persian throne, and their retreat after Cyrus's death in battle in 401 BC. Xenophon took part in the retreat and later assumed a leadership role in it. It is considered an early example of extended first-person military narrative.
- ☐ **Cassius Dio — Roman History:** An eighty-book Greek history of Rome by Cassius Dio, a Roman senator active in the late 2nd and early 3rd centuries AD, covering the period from Rome's legendary founding to Dio's own lifetime. Substantial portions survive only in later summaries and excerpts. It is a significant source for the late Republic and early Empire.
- ☐ **Velleius Paterculus — Compendium of Roman History:** A concise Latin history of Rome by Velleius Paterculus, a Roman military officer, written around 30 AD and dedicated to a consul of that year. It surveys Roman history from its origins to the reign of Tiberius, under whom Velleius had served. It is notably brief in comparison with other surviving Roman histories.
- ☐ **Herodian — History of the Empire:** A Greek history covering the Roman Empire from the death of Marcus Aurelius in 180 AD to the accession of Gordian III in 238 AD, written by Herodian in the mid-3rd century. It covers a period marked by frequent civil war and rapid imperial succession. It is a secondary source alongside Cassius Dio and the Historia Augusta for this period.

Module 4: Plato and Aristotle

About 19.5 hours of reading and 0.1 hours of survey.

The two philosophers whose questions set the agenda for the rest of the list: what justice is, what the soul is, what a good life is, and how we know anything. The passages below are the ones later writers quote most often.

What to take away

- Plato: justice is an order in the soul and the city. True knowledge is of the Forms, and the Cave allegory shows the path from opinion to knowledge.
- Aristotle: the good life is activity in accordance with virtue, virtue is a mean found by practical wisdom, and humans are political animals.
- Heraclitus and Parmenides frame the question of change and permanence that both men answer.

Read

1. ☐ **The Pre-Socratics (the fragments)** (~1.5 h)

Read: The fragments of Heraclitus and of Parmenides only.

Edition: Ed. and tr. Jonathan Barnes, *Early Greek Philosophy* (Penguin); or Kirk, Raven and Schofield, *The Presocratic Philosophers* (Cambridge)

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2. ☐ **Plato — Republic; Symposium; Phaedo; Phaedrus; Timaeus; Gorgias; Laws** (~12 h)

Read: The Apology (not on the list) as a preface. Republic I-II (Thrasymachus and the Ring of Gyges), IV (the parts of the soul), VI.507-VII.521 (sun, line, cave), X.614-621 (Myth of Er). Symposium 201d-212c (Diotima). Phaedo 115-118 (the death of Socrates).

Edition: Plato: *Complete Works*, ed. John M. Cooper (Hackett). Republic tr. Allan Bloom (Basic Books) or Grube/Reeve (Hackett)

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3. ☐ **Aristotle — Nicomachean Ethics; Politics; Physics; Metaphysics; On the Soul; Poetics; Rhetoric** (~6 h)

Read: Nicomachean Ethics I, II, and X.6-8. Politics I.1-2. Poetics 6-14 (tragedy).

Edition: Nicomachean Ethics tr. Terence Irwin (Hackett) or Bartlett and Collins (Chicago); Politics tr. C.D.C. Reeve (Hackett); Poetics tr. Joe Sachs (Focus)

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Check yourself. State in three sentences where Aristotle's ethics departs from Plato's Republic.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Sextus Empiricus — Outlines of Pyrrhonism:** A 2nd-century AD survey of Pyrrhonist skepticism, outlining methods for suspending judgment on matters that cannot be conclusively determined. The text presents opposing arguments on a range of philosophical and scientific questions to demonstrate the case for withholding assent. It is a primary source for ancient skeptical philosophy and was studied during the European Renaissance.
- ☐ **Diogenes Laertius — Lives of the Eminent Philosophers:** A 3rd-century AD compilation of biographical information, sayings, and doctrinal summaries of Greek philosophers from Thales to the Hellenistic schools. It draws on earlier sources, many no longer extant. It remains a primary source of information for several ancient philosophical schools.
- ☐ **Xenophon — Memorabilia; Cyropaedia:** Works by a student of Socrates who was also a soldier and historian of the 4th century BC. The *Memorabilia* is a defense and recollection of Socrates' teaching and character, presenting a more practically oriented portrait than Plato's dialogues. The *Cyropaedia* is a partly fictionalized account of the education and rule of Cyrus the Great, addressing leadership and governance.
- ☐ **Epicurus — Letters and Principal Doctrines:** Surviving letters and maxims of the philosopher (341-270 BC), founder of Epicureanism. The teachings hold that the goal of life is tranquility (*ataraxia*), achieved through the moderate pursuit of pleasure and the removal of fear, particularly fear of death and the gods. Much of Epicurus's original output is lost, and these fragments are preserved largely through later authors such as Diogenes Laertius.
- ☐ **Theophrastus — Characters; the botanical works:** Writings by Aristotle's successor as head of the Lyceum (c. 371-287 BC). The *Characters* is a short collection of sketches describing thirty personality types, such as the flatterer and the boastful man. His botanical treatises, *Enquiry into Plants* and *On the Causes of Plants*, are among the earliest systematic works on plant science.
- ☐ **Philo of Alexandria — On the Creation; Allegorical Interpretation:** Writings of a Hellenistic Jewish philosopher (c. 20 BC-50 AD) who interpreted the Hebrew Bible using categories drawn from Greek philosophy, particularly Platonism. His allegorical method of biblical interpretation influenced later Christian exegetes, including Origen and Clement of Alexandria.

Module 5: Rome: Duty, Empire, and the Stoics

About 20.5 hours of reading and 0.5 hours of survey.

Rome took Greek culture and turned it toward law, duty, and empire, and it produced the Stoic writers still read as practical guides. This module gives you the founding myths, the national epic, and Stoicism in its own words.

What to take away

- Roman virtue is duty to family, gods, and the state (pietas). Aeneas is its model, and Virgil shows what it costs.
- The Stoics separate what is in our power (judgments, choices) from what is not (everything else).
- The Epicureans (Lucretius) offer the rival cure: an atomic universe with no gods to fear and no death to suffer.

Read

1. ☐ **Livy — The History of Rome (Ab Urbe Condita)** (~1.5 h)

Read: The Preface and I.1-16 (the founding); I.57-60 (Lucretia and the end of the kings).

Edition: Tr. Aubrey de Selincourt, *The Early History of Rome and The War with Hannibal* (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

2. ☐ **Plutarch — Parallel Lives; Moralia** (~1.5 h)

Read: The Life of Julius Caesar.

Edition: Tr. Robin Waterfield, *Roman Lives and Greek Lives* (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

3. ☐ **Virgil — The Aeneid** (~6 h)

Read: Books 1, 2, 4, 6, and 12.

Edition: Tr. Robert Fitzgerald (Vintage) or Robert Fagles (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [ToposText](#)

4. ☐ **Lucretius — On the Nature of Things (De Rerum Natura)** (~2 h)

Read: I.1-158 (the invocation and 'nothing from nothing') and III.830-1094 ('death is nothing to us').

Edition: Tr. Martin Ferguson Smith (Hackett); or A.E. Stallings (Penguin)

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5. ☐ **Cicero — On Duties; Tusculan Disputations; On the Nature of the Gods; On Old Age; On Friendship; Letters** (~2 h)

Read: On Duties I.1-60 and On Friendship.

Edition: On Duties tr. Griffin and Atkins (*Cambridge Texts in the History of Political Thought*); On Friendship and On Old Age in Cicero: *On the Good Life*, tr. Michael Grant (Penguin)

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6. ☐ **Cicero — The Dream of Scipio (Somnium Scipionis)** (~0.5 h)

Read: The whole text; it is a few pages.

Edition: In Cicero: The Republic and The Laws, tr. Niall Rudd (Oxford World's Classics)

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7. ☐ **Ovid — Metamorphoses; Fasti; Heroides** (~1.5 h)

Read: Book I (creation, the flood, Apollo and Daphne) and Book X (Orpheus, Pygmalion).

Edition: Tr. Allen Mandelbaum (Harcourt) or Charles Martin (Norton)

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8. ☐ **Tacitus — Annals; Histories; Germania; Agricola** (~1.5 h)

Read: The Agricola; it is short. Note Calgacus's speech (ch. 30).

Edition: Agricola and Germania tr. Harold Mattingly (Penguin); Annals tr. A.J. Woodman (Hackett)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

9. ☐ **Epictetus — Enchiridion; Discourses** (~1 h)

Read: The Enchiridion in full.

Edition: Tr. Robin Hard, Discourses, Fragments, Handbook (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

10. ☐ **Marcus Aurelius — Meditations** (~2 h)

Read: Books 2 and 4.

Edition: Tr. Gregory Hays (Modern Library) or Robin Hard (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

11. ☐ **Seneca — Letters to Lucilius; On the Shortness of Life; Moral Essays** (~1 h)

Read: On the Shortness of Life.

Edition: Tr. Robin Campbell, Letters from a Stoic (Penguin); On the Shortness of Life tr. C.D.N. Costa (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [ToposText](#)

Check yourself. Is Aeneas admirable in Book 4? Answer from Virgil's text, then from Epictetus.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Lucan — Pharsalia (De Bello Civili)**: An unfinished Latin epic poem by Lucan (39-65 AD) on the civil war between Julius Caesar and Pompey. Unlike traditional epic, it largely omits divine intervention, focusing instead on political power, fortune, and the collapse of the Roman Republic.
- ☐ **Statius — Thebaid**: A Latin epic poem by Statius, composed in the first century AD, recounting the mythical war between the sons of Oedipus, Eteocles and Polynices, for control of Thebes. It was widely read in the medieval period, and Dante includes Statius as a character and guide in the Purgatorio.
- ☐ **St. Venantius Fortunatus — Pange Lingua Gloriosi Proelium Certaminis**: A Latin hymn composed by Venantius Fortunatus in the sixth century, celebrating the cross of the crucifixion. Written in classical meter, it was adopted into the liturgy of the Western Church, particularly for Good Friday and Holy Week services.

- ☐ **Virgil — Eclogues; Georgics:** Earlier works by Virgil preceding the Aeneid. The Eclogues (42-39 BC) are pastoral poems depicting shepherds in idealized rural settings; the Georgics (29 BC) is a didactic poem on agriculture, covering farming, viticulture, animal husbandry, and beekeeping. The Fourth Eclogue's prophecy of a child ushering in a new age was later interpreted by some Christian readers as a prefiguration of Christ.
- ☐ **Horace — Odes; Satires; Epistles; Ars Poetica:** Works by the Roman poet Horace, first century BC. The Odes are lyric poems on themes including love, friendship, and mortality, associated with the phrase "carpe diem"; the Satires and Epistles are conversational verse addressing ethics and everyday life; the Ars Poetica offers guidance on the composition of poetry and drama.
- ☐ **Catullus — Poems:** A collection of Latin poems by Catullus, mid-first century BC, including short lyric and invective verses as well as longer poems in various meters. Many poems address a woman referred to as "Lesbia," generally identified with Clodia Metelli, and treat themes of love, friendship, and personal rivalry.
- ☐ **Statius — Silvae; Achilleid:** Additional works by Statius beyond the Thebaid. The Silvae is a collection of occasional poems on subjects including patronage, domestic life, and personal loss; the Achilleid is an unfinished epic on the early life of Achilles, including his time disguised among the daughters of King Lycomedes.
- ☐ **Silius Italicus — Punica:** A Latin epic poem by Silius Italicus, first century AD, the longest surviving poem in Latin, recounting the Second Punic War between Rome and Carthage, including the campaigns of Hannibal.
- ☐ **Valerius Flaccus — Argonautica:** An unfinished Latin epic poem by Valerius Flaccus, first century AD, retelling the story of Jason and the Argonauts' quest for the Golden Fleece. It is modeled on the earlier Greek Argonautica of Apollonius of Rhodes but places greater emphasis on the psychological development of Medea.
- ☐ **Juvenal — Satires:** Sixteen satirical poems by the Roman poet Juvenal, late first to early second century AD, addressing the vices, hypocrisies, and social conditions of imperial Rome. They include the phrases "panem et circenses" (bread and circuses) and "quis custodiet ipsos custodes" (who will guard the guards themselves).
- ☐ **Persius — Satires:** Six satirical poems by Persius (34-62 AD), a Stoic writer whose dense, allusive Latin addresses themes of moral hypocrisy and self-examination in light of Stoic philosophy.
- ☐ **Martial — Epigrams:** A collection of short Latin epigrams by Martial, first century AD, numbering around 1,500, covering subjects from social satire and personal invective to occasional and commemorative verse, and documenting aspects of daily life in Rome.
- ☐ **Claudian — Poems:** Latin poems by Claudian, late fourth to early fifth century AD, a court poet who wrote panegyrics for the Western Roman emperor Honorius and the general Stilicho, and the unfinished mythological epic The Rape of Proserpina. He is generally regarded as among the last poets writing within the classical Latin epic tradition.
- ☐ **Prudentius — Psychomachia:** A Latin allegorical poem by the Christian poet Prudentius, late fourth century AD, depicting a battle between personified virtues and vices for possession of the human soul. It is considered an early and influential example of the allegorical genre in Western literature.
- ☐ **Sedulius — Carmen Paschale:** A Latin epic poem by Sedulius, fifth century AD, retelling episodes from the Gospels, particularly the miracles of Christ, in the style and meter of classical Latin epic. It was used as an educational text in medieval schools.
- ☐ **Juvencus — Evangeliorum Libri:** A Latin epic poem by Juvencus, composed in the early fourth century AD, versifying the life of Christ, based primarily on the Gospel of Matthew, in Virgilian hexameters. It is considered the earliest Christian Latin epic.

- □ **Plautus & Terence — The Comedies:** Roman comic playwrights of the third and second centuries BC, respectively, both adapting plots from Greek New Comedy. Plautus's plays are marked by broad farce, wordplay, and musical elements, while Terence's are noted for more restrained language and psychological characterization. Their surviving plays center on themes including mistaken identity and clever slaves.
- □ **Seneca — The Tragedies:** Latin tragedies attributed to the Stoic philosopher and statesman Seneca the Younger, first century AD, including *Medea*, *Phaedra*, and *Thyestes*, dealing with themes of revenge, tyranny, and extreme passion. They influenced the development of Renaissance tragedy, including English drama.
- □ **Ennius — Annales (fragments):** A fragmentary Latin epic poem by Quintus Ennius (239-169 BC), recounting Roman history from the fall of Troy to Ennius's own time in dactylic hexameter, a meter he introduced to Latin poetry. Only fragments survive, quoted by later authors.
- □ **Tibullus & Propertius — The Elegies:** Roman love elegists of the late first century BC. Propertius's elegies, addressed largely to a woman he calls Cynthia, are noted for their mythological allusion and intensity; Tibullus's poems combine themes of love with idealized depictions of rural life.
- □ **Manilius — Astronomica:** A Latin didactic poem by Manilius, early first century AD, on astronomy and astrology, describing the constellations, the zodiac, and a Stoic-influenced view of a cosmos governed by fate.
- □ **Ausonius — Mosella; Poems:** Latin poems by Ausonius, fourth century AD, a Gallo-Roman poet and teacher. The *Mosella* describes the Moselle River and its surrounding landscape; his other poems address teachers, family members, and daily life. He wrote near the end of the classical Latin literary tradition, in the late Roman period.
- □ **Apuleius — The Golden Ass:** A Latin prose narrative by Apuleius, written in the 2nd century AD and the only ancient Roman novel to survive in its entirety. It follows the protagonist Lucius, transformed into a donkey through magic, through a series of episodes before his restoration to human form through the intervention of the goddess Isis. It includes the embedded tale of Cupid and Psyche.
- □ **Aulus Gellius — Attic Nights:** A Latin miscellany by Aulus Gellius, compiled in the 2nd century AD, consisting of notes on grammar, philosophy, history, and law gathered from his reading and from conversations. It is arranged in twenty books of short, loosely connected chapters. It preserves quotations and information from earlier works that would otherwise be lost.
- □ **Petronius — Satyricon:** A Latin prose work, probably by Gaius Petronius, written in the 1st century AD and surviving only in fragments, combining prose narrative with verse. Its best-preserved section, the *Cena Trimalchionis* ("Trimalchio's Feast"), depicts a lavish banquet hosted by a wealthy freedman. It is regarded as an early example of prose fiction satirizing contemporary Roman society.
- □ **Frontinus — Stratagems:** A Latin work by Sextus Julius Frontinus, a Roman general and administrator of the 1st century AD, cataloging examples of military stratagems drawn from Greek and Roman history. It is organized by category of tactic and intended as a practical supplement to his separate, now-lost treatise on military science. It was used as a reference on tactics in later periods.
- □ **Vegetius — On Military Matters (De Re Militari):** A Latin treatise on Roman military organization and training, written by Publius Flavius Vegetius Renatus, probably in the late 4th century AD. It describes recruitment, training, camp construction, and tactics, drawing on earlier military writings, with the stated aim of restoring earlier standards of discipline. It was widely copied and read as a military manual throughout the medieval period.

- ☐ **Pliny the Younger — Letters:** A collection of Latin letters by Gaius Plinius Caecilius Secundus (Pliny the Younger), a Roman senator and official, written and compiled for publication in the late 1st and early 2nd centuries AD. They include an eyewitness account of the eruption of Vesuvius in 79 AD, which killed his uncle Pliny the Elder, and correspondence with the emperor Trajan concerning the administration of the province of Bithynia, including the treatment of Christians. They provide detailed information on the concerns of the Roman senatorial class.
- ☐ **Varro — On the Latin Language; On Agriculture:** Marcus Terentius Varro was a Roman scholar of the 1st century BC who wrote on a wide range of subjects. *On the Latin Language* examines etymology and grammar and survives only in part; *On Agriculture* (*Res Rusticae*) is a treatise on farming presented in dialogue form. Only a fraction of Varro's extensive output survives.
- ☐ **Columella — On Agriculture (De Re Rustica):** A Latin treatise on farming in twelve books by Lucius Junius Moderatus Columella, written in the 1st century AD. It covers topics including crop cultivation, livestock, viticulture, and estate management. It is among the most complete surviving Roman agricultural treatises, alongside those of Cato and Varro.
- ☐ **Macrobius — Saturnalia:** A Latin work by Macrobius, probably written in the early 5th century AD, structured as a dialogue set during the Roman festival of Saturnalia among a group of learned men. Its participants discuss antiquarian, literary, and philosophical topics, with substantial attention to the works of Virgil. Macrobius's *Commentary on the Dream of Scipio* is a related but separate work.

Module 6: The Bible

About 21.5 hours of reading and 0.2 hours of survey.

Later European literature and philosophy constantly assume a knowledge of the Bible. These passages cover the narrative spine: creation, covenant, exodus, law, wisdom, prophecy, the life of Jesus, and the early church.

What to take away

- One God who creates, makes covenants, and acts in history, unlike the gods of Homer and Hesiod.
- Job and Ecclesiastes question the tradition from within: suffering that is not deserved, and the vanity of all things.
- The Gospels and Paul recast the covenant around the death and resurrection of Jesus and salvation by grace.

Read

1. ☐ **The Pentateuch (the Torah) — Genesis to Deuteronomy** (~5 h)

Read: Genesis 1-4, 6-9, 12, 22, and 37-50. Exodus 1-20 and 32-34.

Edition: Robert Alter, *The Hebrew Bible* (Norton); or any study Bible such as the New Oxford Annotated Bible (NRSV)

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2. ☐ **The Psalms** (~1 h)

Read: Psalms 1, 8, 19, 22, 23, 51, 90, 104, 137, and 139.

Edition: Robert Alter, *The Book of Psalms* (Norton); or a study Bible

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Bible Gateway](#)

3. ☐ **The Book of Job** (~2.5 h)

Read: Chapters 1-14, 38-42.

Edition: Robert Alter, *The Wisdom Books* (Norton); or a study Bible

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Bible Gateway](#)

4. ☐ **The Wisdom Books — Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, the Song of Songs** (~1.5 h)

Read: Ecclesiastes in full; skim Proverbs 1-9.

Edition: Robert Alter, *The Wisdom Books* (Norton); or a study Bible

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Bible Gateway](#)

5. ☐ **The Prophets — Isaiah and the rest** (~2 h)

Read: Isaiah 1-6 and 40-55; Amos 5; Jeremiah 31.

Edition: Robert Alter, *The Hebrew Bible*, vol. 2 (Norton); or a study Bible

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6. ☐ **The Four Gospels — Matthew, Mark, Luke, John** (~5 h)

Read: Mark in full; Matthew 5-7 (the Sermon on the Mount); John 1 and 18-21.

Edition: New Oxford Annotated Bible (NRSV) or the ESV Study Bible; David Bentley Hart, *The New Testament* (Yale) for a literal rendering

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7. ☐ **The Acts of the Apostles** (~1 h)

Read: Acts 1-2, 9, and 17.

Edition: New Oxford Annotated Bible (NRSV) or another study Bible

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8. ☐ **The Pauline Epistles** (~2.5 h)

Read: Romans 1-8; 1 Corinthians 13 and 15.

Edition: New Oxford Annotated Bible (NRSV) or another study Bible

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9. ☐ **The Apocalypse (Revelation)** (~1 h)

Read: Chapters 1, 4-5, and 21-22.

Edition: New Oxford Annotated Bible (NRSV) or another study Bible

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Check yourself. What question does Job ask, and does the voice from the whirlwind answer it?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **St. Jerome (trans.) — The Vulgate:** A Latin translation of the Bible produced largely by Jerome in the late 4th and early 5th centuries AD, translating the Old Testament directly from Hebrew and revising existing Latin translations of the New Testament. It became the standard biblical text of the Western Church for centuries and was affirmed as authoritative by the Council of Trent in 1546.
- ☐ **The Septuagint:** A Greek translation of the Hebrew Scriptures produced in stages beginning in the 3rd century BC, primarily in Alexandria. It was widely used by Greek-speaking Jewish communities and by early Christians, and it is frequently quoted in the New Testament. It also includes several books not present in the later Hebrew canon.
- ☐ **The Deuterocanon — Wisdom of Solomon, Sirach, and the rest:** A group of texts included in the Septuagint and the Latin Vulgate but excluded from the Hebrew Bible and, subsequently, from most Protestant biblical canons following the Reformation. They include the Wisdom of Solomon, Sirach, Tobit, Judith, and 1-2 Maccabees, among others, composed mostly between the 3rd and 1st centuries BC. Catholic and Orthodox traditions regard them as canonical scripture, while Protestant traditions generally classify them as apocrypha.
- ☐ **The Gallican / Roman Psalter:** Latin versions of the Book of Psalms arranged for liturgical recitation in the Western Church. The Gallican Psalter, based on Jerome's revision from the Greek Septuagint, became the version most widely used in medieval monastic worship. These arrangements structured the recitation of the Psalms across a weekly or other fixed cycle in monastic communities.
- ☐ **The Roman Breviary (the Divine Office):** The liturgical book containing the texts for the Liturgy of the Hours, the cycle of prayers, psalms, and readings recited by clergy and religious at fixed times throughout the day. Its structure developed over centuries from early Christian and monastic practice, with the Roman Breviary standardized in its modern form after the Council of Trent. Its use remains obligatory for clergy in the Catholic Church, in updated forms following the Second Vatican Council.
- ☐ **The Roman Missal:** The liturgical book containing the texts and rubrics for the celebration of the Mass in the Roman Rite of the Catholic Church. Its contents developed over many centuries, with major standardized editions issued after the Council of Trent (1570) and following the Second Vatican Council (1970). It includes prayers, scripture-reading assignments, and instructions for the liturgical calendar.
- ☐ **The Roman Martyrology:** The official liturgical martyrology of the Catholic Church, listing saints and martyrs commemorated on each day of the calendar year, along with brief biographical notices. Its current form developed from earlier martyrologies and was revised several times, most recently in 2001 and 2004. It is used in monastic and clerical communities for daily recitation.

- ☐ **The Catholic Epistles — James, Peter, John, Jude:** A group of New Testament letters — James, 1-2 Peter, 1-3 John, and Jude — traditionally described as "catholic" or "general" because they are addressed to broader Christian audiences rather than to specific individual churches. They cover topics including ethical conduct, perseverance under persecution, and warnings against false teaching. Their dates of composition and authorship are debated among scholars.
- ☐ **The Book of Daniel:** A book of the Hebrew Bible combining narrative and apocalyptic visions, set during the Babylonian and Persian periods but generally dated by modern scholars to the 2nd century BC in its final form. It includes stories such as Daniel in the lions' den and the three men in the fiery furnace, alongside symbolic visions of successive empires. It contributed imagery, including the phrase "Son of Man," later taken up in the New Testament.
- ☐ **The Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom:** The most commonly used eucharistic liturgy in the Eastern Orthodox Church, traditionally attributed to St. John Chrysostom (c. 349-407 AD), though its present form developed over subsequent centuries. It structures the celebration of the Eucharist with a fixed sequence of prayers, litanies, and hymns. It is used on most days of the liturgical year outside of specific fasting periods.

Module 7: Augustine and Late Antiquity

About 15 hours of reading and 0.5 hours of survey.

In the late Roman world, early Christian writers combined biblical faith with Greek philosophy. Augustine did so most influentially, and he had read Plotinus before his conversion. Through him the Middle Ages received both traditions.

What to take away

- Christian doctrine (Incarnation, Trinity) was worked out in the vocabulary of Greek philosophy.
- Augustine's Confessions invented the inward autobiography: memory, time, and a restless heart.
- The City of God divides humanity by what it loves, the earthly city and the heavenly one, rather than by political allegiance.

Read

1. ☐ **The Didache** (~0.5 h)

Read: The whole text; it is short.

Edition: In Early Christian Writings: The Apostolic Fathers, tr. Staniforth and Louth (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [New Advent: Fathers](#) · [CCEL](#)

2. ☐ **St. Athanasius — On the Incarnation; The Life of Antony** (~2 h)

Read: The first half of On the Incarnation.

Edition: On the Incarnation, tr. John Behr (St Vladimir's Seminary Press); The Life of Antony, tr. Robert C. Gregg (Paulist)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [New Advent: Fathers](#) · [CCEL](#)

3. ☐ **Plotinus — The Enneads** (~2 h)

Read: Ennead I.6, On Beauty.

Edition: Tr. Stephen MacKenna, abridged by John Dillon (Penguin); or the Gerson edition (Cambridge)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Perseus Greco-Roman](#) · [MIT Internet Classics Archive](#) · [ToposText](#)

4. ☐ **St. Augustine — Confessions** (~6 h)

Read: Books I-IV, VII-IX, and XI (on time).

Edition: Tr. Henry Chadwick (Oxford World's Classics) or Sarah Ruden (Modern Library)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [New Advent: Fathers](#) · [CCEL](#)

5. ☐ **St. Augustine — The City of God; On Christian Doctrine; On the Trinity** (~3 h)

Read: Book XIV.28 (two loves, two cities) and Book XIX (peace and the ends of life).

Edition: City of God tr. Henry Bettenson (Penguin); On Christian Doctrine tr. R.P.H. Green (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [New Advent: Fathers](#) · [CCEL](#)

6. ☐ **St. Benedict of Nursia — The Rule** (~1 h)

Read: The Prologue and chapters 4-7.

Edition: RB 1980: The Rule of St. Benedict, ed. Timothy Fry (Liturgical Press)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [New Advent: Fathers](#) · [CCEL](#)

7. ☐ **Pseudo-Dionysius the Areopagite — The Celestial Hierarchy; The Mystical Theology** (~0.5 h)

Read: The Mystical Theology; it is a few pages.

Edition: Pseudo-Dionysius: The Complete Works, tr. Colm Luibheid (Paulist, Classics of Western Spirituality)

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Check yourself. What did Augustine take from the Platonists, by his own account in Confessions VII, and what did he find missing?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **St. Gregory the Great — Pastoral Care (Liber Regulae Pastoralis):** A treatise written around 590-591 AD by Pope Gregory I, addressing the responsibilities and conduct expected of bishops and other pastors. It discusses how spiritual guidance should be adapted to different types of people and circumstances. It was translated into Old English under King Alfred the Great in the 9th century for distribution to English bishops.
- ☐ **St. Aldhelm — In Praise of Virginité (De Virginitate):** A work by the Anglo-Saxon scholar and bishop Aldhelm (c. 639-709 AD), composed in both prose and verse versions, addressing the theme of religious virginity and chastity. It is written in an elaborate, Latinate style characteristic of Aldhelm's works. It is among the earliest substantial Latin literary works produced in Anglo-Saxon England.
- ☐ **St. Clement of Rome — The First Epistle to the Corinthians:** A letter, likely written in the late 1st century AD, sent from the Christian community in Rome to the church at Corinth to address a leadership dispute there. It is among the earliest surviving Christian texts outside the New Testament and references the authority of church leadership established through apostolic succession. It was read as scripture in some early Christian communities, though it was not included in the eventual New Testament canon.
- ☐ **St. Ignatius of Antioch — The Letters:** Seven letters attributed to Ignatius, bishop of Antioch, written in the early 2nd century AD while he was being transported to Rome for execution. They address church organization, particularly the role of bishops, and describe the Eucharist. They are among the earliest surviving Christian writings outside the New Testament.
- ☐ **St. Justin Martyr — The First and Second Apologies:** Two works by the 2nd-century AD Christian philosopher Justin Martyr, addressed to the Roman emperor and Senate, defending Christianity against common accusations and misunderstandings. Justin argues that elements of truth found in Greek philosophy anticipate the fuller revelation of Christianity. He was executed in Rome, likely around 165 AD.
- ☐ **St. Irenaeus — Against Heresies:** A work written around 180 AD by Irenaeus, bishop of Lyon, refuting various Gnostic teachings and defending the unity of the Old and New Testaments and the goodness of the created material world. It is a primary source of information about 2nd-century Gnostic movements. It contributed to the development of orthodox Christian doctrine on creation and salvation.

- □ **Tertullian — Apology:** A work written around 197 AD by the North African writer Tertullian, defending Christians against Roman legal persecution and popular accusations. Tertullian is credited with significant contributions to Latin Christian theological vocabulary. He later associated with the Montanist movement, considered heterodox by the broader Church.
- □ **St. Clement of Alexandria — The Stromata; The Tutor:** Works by the 2nd-3rd century AD theologian Clement of Alexandria, who taught at the catechetical school in Alexandria. The Stromata ("Miscellanies") discusses the relationship between Greek philosophy and Christian faith; The Tutor (Paedagogus) addresses Christian ethical conduct. Clement argued that philosophy could serve as a preparation for Christian belief.
- □ **Origen — On First Principles:** A systematic theological work by the 3rd-century AD scholar Origen of Alexandria, one of the earliest attempts at a comprehensive Christian theology. It addresses topics including the nature of God, creation, free will, and the eventual state of all rational beings. Some of Origen's speculative positions were later condemned as heterodox by church councils, though his broader influence on Christian theology and biblical scholarship was substantial.
- □ **Eusebius — Ecclesiastical History:** A history of the Christian Church from its origins to the early 4th century AD, written by Eusebius of Caesarea and completed in stages, with a final edition after 324 AD. It preserves excerpts from earlier documents, many otherwise lost, including accounts of persecutions and martyrdoms. It is a primary source for the history of early Christianity.
- □ **St. Hilary of Poitiers — On the Trinity:** A theological work by Hilary, bishop of Poitiers (c. 310-367 AD), written partly during his exile under the Arian-sympathizing emperor Constantius II. It defends the doctrine of the full divinity of Christ against Arian positions that held the Son to be a created, subordinate being. It is among the earliest major Latin treatments of Trinitarian theology.
- □ **St. Basil the Great — On the Holy Spirit; Hexaemeron; To Young Men:** Works by Basil of Caesarea (c. 330-379 AD), one of the three Cappadocian Fathers. On the Holy Spirit argues for the divinity of the Holy Spirit; the Hexaemeron is a series of homilies on the six days of creation; To Young Men advises Christian students on how to make selective use of classical Greek literature. Basil also contributed to the organization of communal monastic life in the Eastern Church.
- □ **St. Gregory of Nazianzus — The Theological Orations:** Five orations delivered by Gregory of Nazianzus (c. 329-390 AD) in Constantinople around 380 AD, addressing Trinitarian theology, particularly the divinity of the Son and the Holy Spirit. Gregory, another of the Cappadocian Fathers, is traditionally given the title "the Theologian" in the Eastern Church. The orations were influential in the doctrinal settlement affirmed at the First Council of Constantinople in 381.
- □ **St. Gregory of Nyssa — The Life of Moses; On the Soul and the Resurrection:** Works by Gregory of Nyssa (c. 335-395 AD), the third of the Cappadocian Fathers. The Life of Moses interprets the biblical account of Moses allegorically as a model of spiritual progress toward God. On the Soul and the Resurrection, structured as a dialogue, discusses the nature of the soul and Christian teaching on resurrection; Gregory developed the concept of epektasis, describing spiritual growth as an unending process.
- □ **St. John Chrysostom — On the Priesthood; the Homilies:** Works by John Chrysostom (c. 347-407 AD), archbishop of Constantinople, known for his skill as a preacher. On the Priesthood discusses the responsibilities and challenges of pastoral ministry. His numerous surviving homilies offer verse-by-verse scriptural commentary along with moral exhortation, including attention to care for the poor.

- ☐ **St. Ambrose — On the Duties of the Clergy; Hexameron:** Works by Ambrose, bishop of Milan (c. 340-397 AD), a former Roman governor. *On the Duties of the Clergy* (*De Officiis*) adapts Cicero's philosophical treatment of ethical duty to a Christian clerical context. Ambrose is known for instructing Augustine of Hippo prior to Augustine's conversion and for requiring the emperor Theodosius I to perform public penance following a massacre at Thessalonica.
- ☐ **St. Jerome — Letters; On Illustrious Men:** Writings of Jerome (c. 342-420 AD), the scholar-monk best known for translating the Vulgate Bible (see Book 15). His surviving letters address scriptural, ascetic, and controversial topics. *On Illustrious Men* is a biographical catalog of Christian authors up to Jerome's own time, modeled on earlier Roman biographical works.
- ☐ **St. John Cassian — Conferences; Institutes:** Works by John Cassian (c. 360-435 AD), who transmitted the monastic practices of the Egyptian desert to the Latin-speaking West. The *Conferences* record discussions attributed to Egyptian monastic teachers on topics including prayer and spiritual discernment. The *Institutes* addresses the organization of monastic communities and discusses eight principal vices; both works influenced the later Rule of St. Benedict.
- ☐ **St. Cyprian — On the Unity of the Church:** A treatise written around 251 AD by Cyprian, bishop of Carthage, addressing a schism within the North African church. It argues for the unity of the Church under the collective authority of its bishops. Cyprian was executed during the persecution under the emperor Valerian in 258 AD.
- ☐ **Lactantius — The Divine Institutes:** A work by the early 4th-century Christian writer Lactantius, presenting Christian doctrine in classical Latin prose style for an educated Roman readership. It critiques polytheistic religion and presents Christianity as compatible with, and superior to, classical philosophical ethics. Lactantius later served as tutor to Crispus, son of the emperor Constantine.
- ☐ **St. Leo the Great — The Tome; the Sermons:** Writings of Pope Leo I (r. 440-461 AD). The *Tome of Leo*, a letter addressing the theological dispute over the nature of Christ, was influential at the Council of Chalcedon in 451, which affirmed that Christ has two natures, divine and human, in one person. His surviving sermons address doctrinal and liturgical topics; Leo is also noted for meeting Attila the Hun in 452, traditionally credited with persuading him not to advance on Rome.
- ☐ **St. Gregory the Great — Dialogues; Moralia in Job:** Works by Pope Gregory I (r. 590-604 AD), also known for the *Pastoral Care* (above) and for sending missionaries to convert Anglo-Saxon England. The *Dialogues* recount lives and miracles of Italian saints, including Benedict of Nursia. The *Moralia in Job* is an extended allegorical and moral commentary on the Book of Job.
- ☐ **Cassiodorus — Institutions of Divine and Secular Learning:** A work by the Roman statesman Cassiodorus (c. 485-585 AD), written after he founded the monastery of Vivarium in southern Italy. The *Institutions* outlines a curriculum combining the study of scripture with the classical liberal arts, intended to guide the monastery's work of copying manuscripts. The monastery's copying activity contributed to the preservation of a number of classical texts.
- ☐ **St. Maximus the Confessor — The Ambigua; Centuries on Love:** Works by the Byzantine monk and theologian Maximus the Confessor (c. 580-662 AD). The *Ambigua* addresses difficult passages in earlier theological writers, particularly Gregory of Nazianzus. Maximus opposed the Monothelite position that Christ had only a divine will, and he was mutilated and exiled for this opposition; his theological positions were later vindicated at the Third Council of Constantinople in 680-681.

- ☐ **St. John of Damascus — On the Orthodox Faith:** A theological work by John of Damascus (c. 675-749 AD), part of his larger Fount of Knowledge, summarizing earlier Greek patristic theology into a systematic exposition. John also wrote in defense of the use of religious images during the Byzantine Iconoclast controversy, arguing that the Incarnation justified depicting Christ. He is traditionally regarded as the last of the major Greek Church Fathers.
- ☐ **The Shepherd of Hermas:** An early Christian text, likely composed in Rome during the 1st or 2nd century AD, presented as a series of visions, mandates, and parables concerning repentance and church discipline. It was widely read in the early Church, and some early sources considered it for inclusion in the New Testament canon, though it was ultimately excluded.
- ☐ **St. Ephrem the Syrian — The Hymns on Paradise and the Nativity:** Hymns composed by Ephrem the Syrian (c. 306-373 AD), a deacon and theologian who wrote in Syriac. The Hymns on Paradise use imagery to explore biblical and theological themes concerning creation and paradise; the Nativity hymns address the birth of Christ. Ephrem's poetic hymns were used for both liturgical and catechetical purposes in the Syriac Christian tradition.
- ☐ **St. Vincent of Lerins — The Commonitory:** A treatise written around 434 AD by Vincent, a monk at the monastery of Lerins, proposing criteria for distinguishing authentic Christian doctrine from heresy. It is known for articulating the standard of belief "held everywhere, always, and by all" (quod ubique, quod semper, quod ab omnibus). It addresses the concept of legitimate doctrinal development within continuity of tradition.

Module 8: The Medieval World

About 22 hours of reading and 1.6 hours of survey.

Three strands in one module: the northern heroic poetry, the scholastic theology of the schools, and the courtly literature that ends in Dante and Chaucer. Boethius comes first because nearly every medieval writer knew him.

What to take away

- The Germanic heroic ethic is loyalty, fame, and courage in the face of fate. Christian writers kept it and reinterpreted it.
- Scholasticism reasons from authorities through objection and reply. Aquinas reconciles Aristotle with Christian faith.
- Dante orders the whole cosmos morally. Chaucer puts the whole of English society on one pilgrimage.

Read

1. ☐ **St. Boethius — The Consolation of Philosophy** (~2 h)

Read: Books I-II (Philosophy's visit and the wheel of Fortune).

Edition: Tr. P.G. Walsh (Oxford World's Classics) or Joel Relihan (Hackett)

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2. ☐ **Anon. — Beowulf** (~3 h)

Read: The whole poem, in a modern verse translation.

Edition: Tr. Seamus Heaney (Norton); or Roy Liuzza (Broadview), with notes

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3. ☐ **The Anglo-Saxon Elegies — The Wanderer; The Seafarer; The Dream of the Rood; The Battle of Maldon** (~0.5 h)

Read: The Wanderer and The Dream of the Rood.

Edition: In *The Word Exchange: Anglo-Saxon Poems in Translation*, ed. Delanty and Matto (Norton); or Kevin Crossley-Holland, *The Anglo-Saxon World* (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

4. ☐ **The Poetic Edda** (~1.5 h)

Read: Voluspa and Havamal.

Edition: Tr. Carolyne Larrington (Oxford World's Classics)

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5. ☐ **The Song of Roland** (~1.5 h)

Read: From the opening through Roland's death.

Edition: Tr. Glyn Burgess (Penguin) or Dorothy L. Sayers (Penguin)

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6. ☐ **St. Anselm — Proslogion; Monologion; Cur Deus Homo** (~0.5 h)

Read: Proslogion 2-4, the ontological argument.

Edition: *Anselm of Canterbury: The Major Works*, ed. Davies and Evans (Oxford World's Classics)

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7. ☐ **St. Thomas Aquinas — Summa Theologiae; Summa contra Gentiles; On Kingship** (~3 h)

Read: Summa Theologiae I q.2 a.3 (the five ways) and I-II qq.90-91 and 94 (law and natural law).

Edition: Summa Theologiae: A Concise Translation, ed. Timothy McDermott (Christian Classics); On Law, Morality, and Politics, ed. Regan and Baumgarth (Hackett); full Dominican Fathers translation free at New Advent

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [CCEL](#)

8. ☐ **Anon. — Sir Gawain and the Green Knight** (~2 h)

Read: The whole poem.

Edition: Tr. Simon Armitage (Norton) or J.R.R. Tolkien (Del Rey / HarperCollins)

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9. ☐ **Dante Alighieri — The Divine Comedy; De Monarchia** (~6 h)

Read: Inferno 1-5, 26, and 33-34; Purgatorio 1 and 30; Paradiso 33.

Edition: Tr. Robert and Jean Hollander (Anchor, facing Italian with notes); or John Ciardi (Signet); or Allen Mandelbaum (Everyman)

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10. ☐ **Geoffrey Chaucer — The Canterbury Tales; Troilus and Criseyde** (~2 h)

Read: The General Prologue and the Pardoner's Tale.

Edition: Middle English: The Riverside Chaucer (Oxford) or the Norton Critical Edition; modern English tr. Nevill Coghill (Penguin)

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Check yourself. Compare Beowulf, Roland, and Gawain. What does each hero owe, and to whom?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Snorri Sturluson — The Prose Edda; Heimskringla:** Works by the thirteenth-century Icelandic chieftain and writer Snorri Sturluson. The Prose Edda is a handbook of Norse mythology and poetic technique, intended to preserve knowledge needed to compose traditional skaldic verse; Heimskringla is a history of the kings of Norway from legendary origins to the twelfth century.
- ☐ **The Nibelungenlied:** An anonymous Middle High German epic poem, composed around 1200, telling of the hero Siegfried, his murder, and the subsequent revenge taken by his widow Kriemhild against her own kin. It draws on earlier Germanic legend and later influenced works including Richard Wagner's Ring cycle.
- ☐ **The Saga of the Volsungs:** An Old Norse prose saga, composed around the thirteenth century, retelling the legend of the Volsung and Niflung families, including the hero Sigurd, the cursed treasure of the dragon Fafnir, and the downfall of the Burgundian kings. It parallels, and shares sources with, the Nibelungenlied.
- ☐ **Njal's Saga; Egil's Saga; Laxdaela Saga:** Icelandic family sagas composed in the thirteenth century, set among Icelandic communities of the ninth through eleventh centuries. They recount feuds, legal disputes, and questions of personal and family honor in a spare prose style, and are considered major examples of medieval Icelandic saga literature.
- ☐ **Caedmon's Hymn:** A short Old English poem of nine lines praising God as creator, attributed by Bede to the herdsman Caedmon in the seventh century. Bede's account describes Caedmon receiving the ability to compose religious verse in a vision. It is among the earliest attested pieces of English poetry.

- ☐ **The Kalevala:** A Finnish epic compiled by Elias Lönnrot in the nineteenth century from Karelian and Finnish oral folk poetry, centering on the wizard-hero Väinämöinen and a magical artifact called the Sampo. It is regarded as the Finnish national epic and influenced later works, including music by Jean Sibelius.
- ☐ **Grettir's Saga (The Saga of Grettir the Strong):** An Icelandic saga composed in the fourteenth century, recounting the life of the outlaw Grettir Asmundarson, including his fights against supernatural adversaries and his years as a fugitive. It is one of the later works in the Icelanders' sagas tradition.
- ☐ **The Vinland Sagas (The Greenlanders' Saga; Erik the Red's Saga):** Two Icelandic sagas describing Norse voyages from Greenland to North America around 1000 AD. They are considered, alongside archaeological evidence at L'Anse aux Meadows, historical sources for pre-Columbian Norse contact with North America.
- ☐ **Hervarar Saga (The Saga of King Heidrek the Wise):** A legendary Icelandic saga incorporating older heroic poetry, centering on a cursed sword named Tyrfing and including a section of riddle contests between King Heidrek and Odin in disguise. J.R.R. Tolkien, who edited and translated the saga, drew on its riddle contest when writing *The Hobbit*.
- ☐ **Widsith; Deor:** Two short Old English poems preserved in the Exeter Book. Widsith presents itself as the catalog of peoples and rulers visited by a legendary wandering minstrel; Deor is spoken by a poet recounting past misfortunes, each followed by the refrain "that passed away, so may this."
- ☐ **Sir Thomas Malory — Le Morte d'Arthur:** An English prose compilation of Arthurian legend completed in the 15th century and printed by William Caxton in 1485. It narrates the formation of the Round Table, the quest for the Holy Grail, and the collapse of Arthur's court amid the affair between Lancelot and Guinevere. It is a principal English-language source for later versions of the Arthurian legend.
- ☐ **The Poem of the Cid:** A Spanish epic poem probably composed in the mid-12th century, recounting the campaigns of Rodrigo Díaz de Vivar, known as El Cid, after his exile by King Alfonso VI of Castile. It describes his military successes, including the conquest of Valencia, and his eventual reconciliation with the king. It is one of the earliest and best-preserved works of medieval Spanish literature.
- ☐ **Chrétien de Troyes — Perceval; Lancelot; Yvain; Erec and Enide:** A 12th-century French poet credited with several verse romances set at the court of King Arthur. His works developed the figure of Lancelot and, in the unfinished *Perceval*, contain the earliest known literary account of the Grail. They combine adventure narrative with the ideology of courtly love.
- ☐ **Wolfram von Eschenbach — Parzival:** A Middle High German verse romance composed in the early 13th century, adapting and extending Chrétien de Troyes's unfinished *Perceval*. It follows the knight Parzival from naive youth through failure to his eventual attainment of the Grail. It later served as the primary literary source for Richard Wagner's opera *Parsifal*.
- ☐ **Gottfried von Strassburg — Tristan:** An unfinished Middle High German verse romance from the early 13th century, retelling the legend of Tristan and Isolde. It centers on the love potion that binds the two despite Isolde's marriage to King Mark of Cornwall. It is one of the principal medieval German treatments of the Tristan story.
- ☐ **Anon. — The Quest of the Holy Grail:** A 13th-century French prose romance, part of the Vulgate (Lancelot-Grail) Cycle, concerning the Arthurian knights' pursuit of the Holy Grail. It emphasizes spiritual purity, and only Galahad, Percival, and Bors are shown achieving the Grail. It recasts the earlier chivalric romance tradition in explicitly religious terms.
- ☐ **The Mabinogion:** A collection of medieval Welsh prose tales compiled in manuscripts of the 12th to 14th centuries, drawing on earlier oral tradition. It includes the Four Branches of the Mabinogi as well as several Arthurian tales. It is a major source for early Welsh narrative and for Arthurian material predating the French romances.

- ☐ **Giovanni Boccaccio — The Decameron:** A collection of 100 novellas in Italian prose, written around 1349-1353, framed as stories told by ten young Florentines sheltering outside the city during the Black Death. The tales range across comic, tragic, and erotic subjects drawn from varied sources. It influenced later European prose fiction, including Chaucer.
- ☐ **Guillaume de Lorris & Jean de Meun — The Romance of the Rose:** A French allegorical poem in two parts. The first, by Guillaume de Lorris (c. 1230), presents a dream-vision of the pursuit of courtly love, personified as a rose; the second, by Jean de Meun (c. 1275), adds extensive philosophical, satirical, and encyclopedic digressions. It was widely read across medieval Europe and partly translated into English, in a version once attributed to Chaucer.
- ☐ **Ludovico Ariosto — Orlando Furioso:** An Italian epic poem first published in 1516 and completed in its final form in 1532, continuing the narrative begun in Boiardo's *Orlando Innamorato*. It follows the knight Orlando's madness brought on by unrequited love for Angelica, alongside numerous interwoven episodes involving Charlemagne's paladins and their Saracen adversaries. It is written in ottava rima.
- ☐ **Torquato Tasso — Jerusalem Delivered:** An Italian epic poem published in 1581, presenting a fictionalized account of the First Crusade and the 1099 siege of Jerusalem. It combines historical military narrative with episodes of romance and supernatural enchantment. It is considered a major work of the later Italian Renaissance epic tradition.
- ☐ **Edmund Spenser — The Faerie Queene:** An English allegorical epic poem; its first three books were published in 1590 and further books in 1596, with the work left unfinished at Spenser's death. Each completed book follows a knight representing a particular virtue in service to the Faerie Queene, a figure generally understood to represent Queen Elizabeth I. It is written in a nine-line stanza form now called the Spenserian stanza.
- ☐ **Jean Froissart — Chronicles:** A French-language chronicle covering events in Western Europe, chiefly during the Hundred Years' War, from the 1320s into the early 15th century. Froissart drew on eyewitness testimony and his own travels among the nobility of England, France, and the Low Countries. The Chronicles are a major narrative source for the political and military history of the period.
- ☐ **Petrarch — Canzoniere:** A collection of 366 poems, mostly sonnets, composed in Italian by Francesco Petrarca over several decades of the 14th century, largely addressed to a woman he calls Laura. It helped establish the sonnet sequence as a poetic form and influenced European love poetry for centuries. It is also known by its Latin title, *Rerum vulgarium fragmenta*.
- ☐ **Francois Villon — The Testament:** A poem written in 1461 by Francois Villon, a French poet whose recorded life included periods of crime and imprisonment. Framed as a mock last will and testament, it addresses mortality, poverty, and the passage of time, combining formal ballades with satirical and autobiographical passages. It is among the best-known works of later medieval French poetry.
- ☐ **Marie de France — The Lais:** A collection of twelve narrative poems in Old French, composed in the late 12th century by a poet identified only as Marie, believed to have been active at the English court. The lais are short verse tales concerning love, often incorporating supernatural or Breton folkloric elements. Marie de France is one of the few named women writers of the medieval period.
- ☐ **Beroul & Thomas — The Romance of Tristan:** Two separate 12th-century Old French verse versions of the Tristan and Isolde legend, attributed respectively to Beroul and to a poet known as Thomas of Britain, both surviving only in fragments. They are among the earliest literary treatments of the Tristan story. They were drawn on by later versions, including Gottfried von Strassburg's *Tristan*.

- ☐ **Amadis of Gaul:** A prose chivalric romance of Iberian origin, published in its best-known Spanish form by Garci Rodriguez de Montalvo in 1508, though earlier versions likely circulated before then. It follows the adventures of the knight Amadis and was widely popular across 16th-century Europe. It is referenced in Cervantes's *Don Quixote* as one of the chivalric romances read by the protagonist.
- ☐ **Aucassin et Nicolette:** An anonymous French work of the late 12th or early 13th century, combining alternating passages of sung verse and spoken prose, a form known as a *chante-fable*. It tells of the love between the nobleman Aucassin and Nicolette, an enslaved woman, and includes elements parodying conventions of contemporary romance. It survives in a single manuscript.
- ☐ **Lebor Gabala Erenn (The Book of Invasions):** A medieval Irish compilation of prose and verse, surviving in several recensions from around the 11th century onward, presenting a pseudo-historical account of Ireland's successive legendary settlements. It traces the ancestry of the Irish to the Gaels, described as the last of the invading peoples to arrive. It combines native mythological material with elements adapted from biblical and classical history.
- ☐ **Tain Bo Cuailnge (The Cattle Raid of Cooley):** The central narrative of the Ulster Cycle of early Irish literature, surviving in manuscripts from the 12th century onward though reflecting older oral material. It recounts Queen Medb of Connacht's invasion of Ulster to seize a prized bull, and the young hero Cu Chulainn's defense of the province. It is composed primarily in prose with interspersed verse.
- ☐ **The Ulster Cycle — Bricriu's Feast; The Destruction of Da Derga's Hostel; The Wooing of Etain:** A group of early Irish narratives centered on the warriors of King Conchobar mac Nessa and the hero Cu Chulainn. Bricriu's Feast concerns a contest over a champion's portion at a feast; The Destruction of Da Derga's Hostel recounts the death of King Conaire; The Wooing of Etain involves the otherworldly figure Midir. They survive chiefly in medieval manuscripts such as the *Book of the Dun Cow*.
- ☐ **The Mythological Cycle — Cath Maige Tuired:** A body of early Irish narrative concerning the Tuatha De Danann, a supernatural race said to have inhabited Ireland before the arrival of the Gaels. Cath Maige Tuired recounts their conflict with the Fomorians for control of Ireland. It survives in medieval manuscripts reflecting older traditional material.
- ☐ **The Fenian Cycle — Acallam na Senorach; The Pursuit of Diarmuid and Grainne:** A body of early Irish literature centered on the warrior Finn mac Cumhaill and his band, the Fianna. *Acallam na Senorach*, composed around the 12th century, frames surviving members of the Fianna recounting earlier tales to St. Patrick. The *Pursuit of Diarmuid and Grainne* tells of the elopement of Grainne, betrothed to Finn, with the warrior Diarmuid.
- ☐ **The Immrama — The Voyage of Bran; The Voyage of Mael Duin:** Early Irish narratives belonging to the *immram*, or "voyage," genre, describing sea journeys to supernatural otherworld islands. The *Voyage of Bran* dates to around the 8th century; the *Voyage of Mael Duin* is somewhat later and combines pre-Christian and Christian elements. They are among the earliest surviving examples of the genre.
- ☐ **The Annals of the Four Masters; The Annals of Ulster:** Chronological compilations of Irish history. The *Annals of the Four Masters* were compiled in the 17th century from earlier sources, covering events from legendary antiquity to 1616. The *Annals of Ulster* cover a comparable span and were compiled from the 15th century onward using earlier annalistic material.
- ☐ **Senchas Mar (the Brehon law tracts):** A collection of early Irish legal texts, compiled around the 8th century, forming part of the native Irish body of customary law known as Brehon law. It addresses areas including contract, status, and compensation, administered through mechanisms distinct from later feudal or common law systems. It is among the earliest vernacular law codes recorded in Europe.

- ☐ **Lebor na hUidre; The Book of Leinster:** Two principal medieval Irish manuscripts. Lebor na hUidre ("Book of the Dun Cow"), compiled around 1100, is the oldest surviving manuscript written wholly in Irish. The Book of Leinster dates from the 12th century. Both preserve texts of the Ulster Cycle and other early Irish literature, copied by monastic scribes.
- ☐ **The Welsh Triads (Trioedd Ynys Prydein):** A collection of medieval Welsh texts organizing traditional lore into groups of three related figures or events, used as a mnemonic device by poets and storytellers. The triads reference people and episodes from Welsh legend, including material connected to Arthur. They survive in manuscripts from the 13th century onward, though the underlying material is older.
- ☐ **Aneirin — Y Gododdin:** An early Welsh poem attributed to the poet Aneirin, commemorating warriors of the Gododdin kingdom killed at the Battle of Catraeth, traditionally dated to around 600 AD. It survives in a 13th-century manuscript known as the Book of Aneirin. It contains a passage sometimes cited as the earliest surviving reference to Arthur.
- ☐ **The Book of Taliesin:** A 14th-century Welsh manuscript containing poems attributed to the 6th-century bard Taliesin, though scholars date much of the material to later centuries. The collection includes praise poetry alongside poems with mythological and riddling content, some employing a shape-shifting first-person voice. It is a primary source for early Welsh bardic poetry.
- ☐ **The Black Book of Carmarthen:** A Welsh manuscript dating to around the mid-13th century, considered the earliest surviving manuscript written wholly in Welsh. It contains varied early poetry, including material referencing Arthur and Myrddin, the figure later associated with Merlin. It is held at the National Library of Wales.
- ☐ **The Red Book of Hergest:** A large Welsh manuscript compiled in the late 14th or early 15th century, containing prose tales including the Mabinogion along with extensive poetry. It is one of the principal manuscript sources for medieval Welsh literature. It is held at the Bodleian Library, Oxford.
- ☐ **St. Patrick — Confessio; Letter to Coroticus:** Two Latin texts generally accepted as the authentic writings of St. Patrick, the missionary credited with a central role in Ireland's conversion to Christianity, probably written in the 5th century. The Confessio is autobiographical, describing his capture and enslavement in Ireland, his escape, and his return as a missionary. The Letter to Coroticus condemns a raid by a British warlord against Patrick's converts.
- ☐ **Adomnan of Iona — The Life of St. Columba:** A Latin hagiography written around 700 AD by Adomnan, abbot of Iona, recounting the life of St. Columba, the 6th-century Irish monk who founded the monastery of Iona and is associated with the conversion of parts of Scotland. It is organized around prophecies, miracles, and visions attributed to Columba. It also provides incidental information on early monastic life.
- ☐ **The Voyage of St. Brendan (Navigatio Sancti Brendani):** A Latin narrative, probably composed in the 9th or 10th century, recounting a legendary sea voyage by the Irish abbot St. Brendan in search of a paradise called the Promised Land of the Saints. It combines the earlier immram genre with explicitly Christian pilgrimage themes. It circulated widely in medieval Europe in numerous translations.
- ☐ **Nennius — Historia Brittonum:** A Latin compilation of British history and legend traditionally attributed to Nennius, dating to around the early 9th century. It is among the earliest sources to mention Arthur, listing twelve battles he is said to have fought against Saxon invaders. It combines genealogical, chronological, and legendary material.

- ☐ **Buile Suibhne (The Frenzy of Sweeney):** A medieval Irish prose and verse narrative, surviving in a manuscript of around the 17th century though reflecting an older story, telling of King Suibhne, who is cursed with madness and transformed into a bird-like wanderer after a battle. The text combines narrative prose with lyric verse attributed to Suibhne during his exile. It has been the subject of modern translations and adaptations, including by Seamus Heaney and Flann O'Brien.
- ☐ **Early Irish Nature Lyrics (incl. "Pangur Ban"):** A body of short lyric poems composed by monastic scribes in medieval Ireland, often recorded in manuscript margins, addressing subjects such as hermit life, the natural world, and the seasons. "Pangur Ban," probably composed in the 8th or 9th century, compares the poet's pursuit of scholarship to his cat's pursuit of mice. These poems are noted for their concision and personal tone.
- ☐ **Sanas Cormaic (Cormac's Glossary):** An early Irish glossary traditionally attributed to Cormac mac Cuilennain, bishop-king of Munster, compiled around the 9th or 10th century. It explains Irish words through etymology, some accurate and some fanciful, along with associated lore and legend. It is considered an early example of a vernacular etymological dictionary in Europe.
- ☐ **Dafydd ap Gwilym — Poems:** A Welsh poet active in the 14th century whose surviving corpus consists mainly of love poetry and poems addressing the natural world. He combined traditional Welsh bardic meters, particularly the cywydd form, with themes associated with continental courtly love poetry. He is considered a major poet of medieval Wales.
- ☐ **Orosius — History Against the Pagans:** A Latin work by Paulus Orosius, written around 417-418 AD at the encouragement of Augustine of Hippo, presenting a universal history intended to argue that pre-Christian history included calamities comparable to those following Rome's decline. It was written partly in response to claims that Christianity was responsible for the sack of Rome in 410. It was widely used as a standard historical reference throughout the Middle Ages.
- ☐ **St. Bede — Ecclesiastical History of the English People:** A Latin history completed in 731 AD by the Northumbrian monk Bede, covering the Christianization of the Anglo-Saxon peoples of England from the Roman period to Bede's own time. It draws on earlier written sources and correspondence with contemporary informants. It is a primary source for early English history and helped popularize dating events from the birth of Christ (AD).
- ☐ **Gregory of Tours — The History of the Franks:** A Latin chronicle by Gregory, bishop of Tours, written in the late 6th century, covering the history of the Frankish kingdoms under the Merovingian dynasty, with particular attention to Gregory's own time. It combines political narrative with ecclesiastical material and accounts of miracles. It is a principal source for Merovingian Gaul.
- ☐ **Einhard — The Life of Charlemagne:** A Latin biography of the emperor Charlemagne written by Einhard, a member of his court, in the 820s or 830s, modeled explicitly on Suetonius's Lives of the Caesars. It covers Charlemagne's conquests, administration, and personal habits and appearance. It is a principal source for Charlemagne's life and the Carolingian court.
- ☐ **Asser — The Life of King Alfred:** A Latin biography of King Alfred of Wessex, traditionally attributed to Asser, a Welsh monk who served at Alfred's court, probably written around 893. It covers Alfred's reign, including his wars against Viking invasions and his patronage of learning and translation. Its authenticity and precise date have been the subject of some scholarly debate.
- ☐ **The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle:** A set of related annalistic chronicles in Old English, originating during the reign of Alfred the Great in the late 9th century and continued at various monastic centers, with some versions extending into the 12th century. It records events in English history year by year. It is among the earliest sustained historical works composed in a European vernacular language.

- ☐ **Gildas — On the Ruin of Britain:** A Latin text by the British monk Gildas, probably written in the 6th century, combining historical narrative with a polemical condemnation of contemporary British rulers, whom Gildas blames for inviting Saxon settlement and conquest. It is one of the few surviving near-contemporary sources for sub-Roman Britain. Its historical reliability is debated among historians.
- ☐ **Jordanes — Getica:** A Latin history of the Goths written by Jordanes in the mid-6th century, based substantially on the lost Gothic history of Cassiodorus. It presents an origin narrative for the Gothic peoples and traces their history into Jordanes's own time. It is a major surviving source for early Gothic history, though its reliability is debated.
- ☐ **Paul the Deacon — History of the Lombards:** A Latin history of the Lombards, a Germanic people who established a kingdom in Italy, written by Paul the Deacon in the late 8th century at the Carolingian court. It covers Lombard history from their legendary origins to the mid-8th century, combining legendary and historical material. It is the principal narrative source for early Lombard history.
- ☐ **Geoffrey of Monmouth — The History of the Kings of Britain:** A Latin pseudo-historical work completed around 1136, presenting a chronicle of British kings from a legendary Trojan founder to the 7th century, including an extensive account of King Arthur. Largely legendary or invented in content, it drew on earlier chronicle material as well as Geoffrey's own additions. It was highly influential in the development of the Arthurian legend and of subsequent medieval historical writing.
- ☐ **Procopius — The Wars; The Secret History:** Works by Procopius of Caesarea, a Greek historian of the 6th century who served as secretary to the Byzantine general Belisarius. The Wars is an official account of Emperor Justinian's military campaigns; The Secret History, apparently intended for posthumous circulation, offers a critical account of Justinian, his wife Theodora, and Belisarius. The two works present markedly different portrayals of the same court and events.
- ☐ **William of Malmesbury — Deeds of the Kings of the English:** A Latin history of the kings of England from the 5th century to William's own time, written by the monk William of Malmesbury in the 1120s. It draws on and evaluates a range of earlier written sources with attention to source criticism. It is considered a significant work of English historical writing in the period following the Norman Conquest.
- ☐ **Jacobus de Voragine — The Golden Legend:** A Latin compilation of hagiographies of saints, assembled by the Dominican friar Jacobus de Voragine around 1260. It was extensively copied, translated, and later printed, becoming one of the most widely circulated texts of the later Middle Ages. It influenced the iconography of saints in medieval art.
- ☐ **Saxo Grammaticus — Gesta Danorum:** A Latin history of the Danes written by Saxo Grammaticus around 1200, covering legendary and historical Danish history from earliest times to the late 12th century. It includes the story of Amleth, later used as a source for Shakespeare's Hamlet. It combines Norse legendary material with chronicle history.
- ☐ **Adam of Bremen — Deeds of the Bishops of Hamburg:** A Latin ecclesiastical history written around 1075-1076 by Adam, a canon of the church of Bremen, covering the history of the archbishopric of Hamburg-Bremen and its missionary activity in Scandinavia. It includes early descriptions of Scandinavian geography and pagan religious practice, including the temple at Uppsala, and one of the earliest European references to Vinland.
- ☐ **Anna Komnene — The Alexiad:** A Greek history written by Anna Komnene, daughter of the Byzantine emperor Alexios I Komnenos, in the mid-12th century, covering her father's reign from roughly 1069 to 1118. It includes an account of the arrival of the First Crusade in Byzantine territory. It is regarded as an early example of historical writing by a woman.

- ☐ **Otto of Freising — The Two Cities; Deeds of Frederick Barbarossa:** Works by Otto, bishop of Freising, a 12th-century historian and member of the Hohenstaufen dynasty. The Two Cities (*Historia de Duabus Civitatibus*) is a universal history structured around Augustine's concept of the earthly and heavenly cities. Deeds of Frederick Barbarossa is a biography of Otto's nephew, Emperor Frederick I, left unfinished at Otto's death and completed by his continuator Rahewin.
- ☐ **Geoffroi de Villehardouin — The Conquest of Constantinople:** An Old French prose account of the Fourth Crusade (1202-1204) by Geoffroi de Villehardouin, a knight and participant who served as a marshal and negotiator during the campaign. It recounts the diversion of the crusade to Constantinople and the city's capture and sack in 1204. It is considered one of the earliest examples of French historical prose.
- ☐ **Jean de Joinville — The Life of Saint Louis:** A French biography of King Louis IX of France, written by Jean de Joinville, a nobleman who accompanied Louis on the Seventh Crusade, completed around 1309. It combines an account of the crusade with personal anecdotes and reflections on Louis's character and piety. It is a primary source for the reign of Louis IX and for 13th-century French court life.
- ☐ **John Scotus Eriugena — Periphyseon (On the Division of Nature):** A ninth-century Latin philosophical work structured as a dialogue, presenting a Neoplatonic account of the divisions of nature and the procession and return of all things to God. Eriugena translated the works of Pseudo-Dionysius into Latin, which influenced the treatise's system. Some of its propositions were later condemned by church authorities.
- ☐ **Peter Abelard — Sic et Non; Historia Calamitatum:** Abelard (1079-1142) was a French logician and theologian. *Sic et Non* juxtaposes contradictory statements from patristic authorities on theological questions without resolving them, a format associated with the development of scholastic method. The *Historia Calamitatum* is an autobiographical account of his life, including his relationship with Heloise.
- ☐ **Peter Lombard — The Sentences:** A twelfth-century compilation organizing patristic and other theological opinions into four books covering God, creation, Christ, and the sacraments. It became the standard theology textbook in medieval universities, and commentary on it was a standard exercise for theologians, including Aquinas.
- ☐ **Hugh of St. Victor — Didascalicon:** A twelfth-century guide to the arts and sciences and to methods of reading and study, written by a canon of the Abbey of Saint-Victor in Paris. It organizes secular and sacred learning within a framework oriented toward biblical study and contemplation.
- ☐ **Richard of St. Victor — On the Trinity; The Mystical Ark:** Richard (d. 1173), a canon of Saint-Victor, wrote *On the Trinity*, which argues for the necessity of plurality in God from the nature of perfect love, and *The Mystical Ark*, which describes stages of contemplation.
- ☐ **St. Bernard of Clairvaux — On Loving God; Sermons on the Song of Songs:** Bernard (1090-1153) was a Cistercian abbot and theologian influential in Church reform and the Second Crusade. *On Loving God* discusses degrees of love of God; his sermons on the Song of Songs interpret the biblical text allegorically as depicting the relationship between the soul and God.
- ☐ **St. Albert the Great — On the Soul; the commentaries on Aristotle:** Albertus Magnus (c. 1200-1280) was a Dominican friar who wrote extensive commentaries on Aristotle's works, incorporating them into Christian scholarship, and also wrote on natural science. He was a teacher of Thomas Aquinas.
- ☐ **St. Bonaventure — The Journey of the Mind to God:** Bonaventure (1221-1274) was a Franciscan theologian. This short treatise (*Itinerarium Mentis in Deum*) describes a six-stage ascent of the soul toward God through contemplation of the created world, the self, and divine attributes.

- ☐ **John Duns Scotus — Ordinatio:** Scotus (c. 1266-1308) was a Franciscan philosopher and theologian known for his doctrines of univocity of being, formal distinction, and haecceity (individual "thisness"). The *Ordinatio* is his major work, a revision of his lecture commentary on Peter Lombard's *Sentences*.
- ☐ **William of Ockham — Sum of Logic:** Ockham (c. 1287-1347) was an English Franciscan philosopher associated with nominalism, the position that universals do not exist independently of the mind. The *Summa Logicae* is a treatise on logic and philosophy of language; Ockham is also known for the methodological principle called Ockham's razor.
- ☐ **Ramon Llull — Ars Magna; Blanquerna:** Llull (c. 1232-1316) was a Catalan philosopher and missionary. The *Ars Magna* presents a combinatorial system intended to demonstrate religious truths logically; *Blanquerna* is a prose narrative about a man who becomes pope, written in Catalan.
- ☐ **Nicholas of Cusa — On Learned Ignorance:** Nicholas of Cusa (1401-1464) was a cardinal and philosopher. *De Docta Ignorantia* (1440) argues that human knowledge of the infinite God is necessarily limited and discusses the coincidence of opposites in the divine.
- ☐ **St. John Climacus — The Ladder of Divine Ascent:** A seventh-century Greek text by John, abbot of Mount Sinai, describing thirty steps of ascetic and spiritual progress. It is used in Eastern Orthodox monastic practice, particularly during Lent.
- ☐ **St. Symeon the New Theologian — The Discourses; Hymns of Divine Love:** Symeon (949-1022) was a Byzantine monk and mystical writer who wrote of direct experiential knowledge of God, including visions of divine light, attainable during life. His writings influenced later Orthodox spirituality, including Palamism.
- ☐ **St. Gregory Palamas — The Triads (In Defense of the Holy Hesychasts):** A fourteenth-century Byzantine theologian, Palamas wrote in defense of hesychast monastic practice, including the Jesus Prayer. He formulated a distinction between God's essence, which is unknowable, and God's energies, through which humans experience divine grace.
- ☐ **Meister Eckhart — The Sermons:** Eckhart (c. 1260-1328) was a German Dominican theologian and mystic. His vernacular and Latin sermons discuss the soul's relationship to the Godhead using paradoxical and apophatic language; some propositions drawn from his teaching were condemned posthumously by Pope John XXII.
- ☐ **Johannes Tauler — The Sermons:** Tauler (c. 1300-1361) was a German Dominican preacher associated with Rhineland mysticism and a student of Eckhart's teaching. His sermons address detachment and the inner spiritual life in more practical terms than Eckhart's.
- ☐ **Jan van Ruusbroec — The Spiritual Espousals:** Ruusbroec (1293-1381) was a Flemish mystic. This work describes three stages of the spiritual life — active, interior, and contemplative — culminating in union with God, using the image of spiritual marriage.
- ☐ **St. Hildegard of Bingen — Scivias:** Hildegard (1098-1179) was a Benedictine abbess, composer, and writer. *Scivias* records a series of visions concerning creation, salvation history, and the Church, accompanied by theological commentary.
- ☐ **Richard Rolle — The Fire of Love:** Rolle (c. 1300-1349) was an English hermit and mystical writer. The *Fire of Love* (*Incendium Amoris*) describes his religious experiences in terms of physical sensations of heat and sweetness and the perception of song.
- ☐ **Walter Hilton — The Scale of Perfection:** Hilton (d. 1396) was an English Augustinian canon. This work describes the soul's progress from active religious observance toward contemplative union with God, addressed to a reader pursuing the contemplative life.

- ☐ **Anon. — The Cloud of Unknowing:** An anonymous fourteenth-century English text on contemplative prayer. It instructs the reader to set aside concepts and images of God, placing them beneath a "cloud of forgetting," and to approach God through an act of will described as "naked intent."
- ☐ **Julian of Norwich — Revelations of Divine Love:** Julian (c. 1342-1416) was an English anchoress. The text records and reflects on a series of visions ("showings") she experienced in 1373 concerning the Passion of Christ and the nature of divine love, including the statement "all shall be well."
- ☐ **St. Catherine of Siena — The Dialogue:** Catherine (1347-1380) was an Italian Dominican tertiary involved in Church affairs, including efforts to return the papacy to Rome from Avignon. The Dialogue records a series of conversations between the soul and God, dictated by Catherine.
- ☐ **Thomas a Kempis — The Imitation of Christ:** A devotional text composed in Latin in the fifteenth century, traditionally attributed to Thomas a Kempis, an Augustinian canon. It consists of four books offering guidance on humility, detachment from worldly concerns, and imitation of Christ.
- ☐ **Boethius — The Theological Tractates (incl. De Trinitate):** Short Latin treatises by Boethius applying logical analysis to questions concerning the Trinity and the person of Christ. They were widely studied in medieval schools alongside the Consolation of Philosophy. (Companion to the Consolation, Book I.)
- ☐ **Henry Suso — The Little Book of Eternal Wisdom:** Suso (c. 1295-1366) was a German Dominican mystic and a student of Eckhart. This devotional work centers on meditation on the suffering of Christ and was widely circulated in the late medieval period.
- ☐ **Jean Gerson — On Mystical Theology:** Gerson (1363-1429) was chancellor of the University of Paris. His writings on mystical theology sought to distinguish contemplative experience from error and to address the subject within an academic and pastoral framework.
- ☐ **Joachim of Fiore — Exposition of the Apocalypse:** Joachim (c. 1135-1202) was a Calabrian abbot who proposed a theology of history divided into three ages, associated with the Father, the Son, and a coming age of the Spirit. His ideas influenced later apocalyptic and reform movements.

Module 9: Judaism and Islam

About 17 hours of reading and 0.9 hours of survey.

Rabbinic law and ethics, the Qur'an and hadith, the medieval argument over philosophy and revelation, and Sufi poetry. The philosophers in this module passed Aristotle on to the Latin scholastics of Module 8.

What to take away

- Rabbinic Judaism keeps both sides of an argument on record. The Torah is studied and interpreted in every generation.
- The Qur'an stresses God's oneness (tawhid), prophecy, and judgment. Hadith and the life of the Prophet set the pattern of practice.
- Al-Ghazali, Averroes, and Maimonides debate whether philosophy serves revelation or threatens it. The Sufi poets describe the way of love.

Read

1. ☐ **Pirkei Avot (The Ethics of the Fathers)** (~1 h)

Read: The whole text.

Edition: Koren Pirkei Avot (Koren); free on Sefaria

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Sefaria](#)

2. ☐ **The Babylonian Talmud (Talmud Bavli)** (~1 h)

Read: Bava Metzia 59a-b (the oven of Akhnai) and Shabbat 31a (Hillel on the whole Torah).

Edition: Koren Talmud Bavli, Noe Edition (Koren); free on Sefaria (William Davidson edition). Guide: Barry Holtz, Back to the Sources (Simon & Schuster)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Sefaria](#)

3. ☐ **The Qur'an** (~4 h)

Read: Suras 1; 2:1-39 and 2:255; 12 (Joseph); 18; 19 (Mary); 55; 112-114.

Edition: Tr. M.A.S. Abdel Haleem (Oxford World's Classics); The Study Quran, ed. Seyyed Hossein Nasr (HarperOne); free at [Quran.com](#)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

4. ☐ **Al-Nawawi — Forty Hadith** (~1 h)

Read: The whole collection.

Edition: Tr. Ezzeddin Ibrahim and Denys Johnson-Davies (Islamic Texts Society)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

5. ☐ **Al-Ghazali — The Incoherence of the Philosophers; The Revival of the Religious Sciences; Deliverance from Error** (~2 h)

Read: Deliverance from Error.

Edition: Deliverance from Error, tr. R.J. McCarthy (Fons Vitae); The Incoherence of the Philosophers, tr. Michael Marmura (Brigham Young)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

6. ☐ **Averroes (Ibn Rushd) — The Incoherence of the Incoherence; The Decisive Treatise; the Aristotle commentaries** (~1.5 h)

Read: The Decisive Treatise.

Edition: The Decisive Treatise, tr. Charles Butterworth (Brigham Young); Tahafut al-Tahafut tr. Simon van den Bergh (Gibb Memorial Trust)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

7. ☐ **Ibn Tufayl — Hayy ibn Yaqzan** (~1.5 h)

Read: The main narrative, from Hayy's birth to his meeting with Absal.

Edition: Tr. Lenn Evan Goodman, Hayy Ibn Yaqzan (Chicago)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

8. ☐ **Moses Maimonides — The Guide for the Perplexed** (~1.5 h)

Read: The Introduction to Part I and I.50-60 (negative attributes).

Edition: Tr. Shlomo Pines, The Guide of the Perplexed (Chicago, 2 vols.); abridged ed. Julius Guttman (Hackett)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

9. ☐ **Rumi — The Masnavi; Diwan-e Shams-e Tabrizi; Fihi Ma Fihi** (~1 h)

Read: The opening of the Masnavi (the song of the reed) and a selection of ghazals.

Edition: The Masnavi, Book One, tr. Jawid Mojaddedi (Oxford World's Classics); ghazals tr. A.J. Arberry, Mystical Poems of Rumi (Chicago)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

10. ☐ **Attar — The Conference of the Birds** (~1.5 h)

Read: The frame story and the section on the seven valleys.

Edition: Tr. Afkham Darbandi and Dick Davis (Penguin); or Sholeh Wolpe (Norton)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

11. ☐ **Ibn Khaldun — The Muqaddimah** (~1 h)

Read: Selections on asabiyya (group solidarity) and the life cycle of dynasties.

Edition: Tr. Franz Rosenthal, abridged by N.J. Dawood, The Muqaddimah (Princeton)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Quran.com](#)

Check yourself. Set Averroes' Decisive Treatise beside Aquinas on faith and reason. Where do they agree?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **The Mishnah:** Compiled around 200 AD under Judah ha-Nasi, this text organizes Jewish oral law into six orders covering agriculture, festivals, family law, damages, holy things, and ritual purity. It records positions of earlier rabbis (tannaim) and forms the base text for later rabbinic commentary.
- ☐ **The Tosefta:** A companion collection of tannaitic teachings organized parallel to the Mishnah's structure, containing material not included in the Mishnah, including additional rulings and discussions.
- ☐ **The Jerusalem Talmud (Talmud Yerushalmi):** Compiled in the Land of Israel and completed earlier than the Babylonian Talmud, around the 4th-5th century AD. It comments on the Mishnah and preserves traditions and rulings distinct from those in the Babylonian Talmud.
- ☐ **The Midrash — Midrash Rabbah; Pirkei de-Rabbi Eliezer; Tanhuma:** Collections of rabbinic biblical interpretation compiled over several centuries, combining legal exposition (halakhah) with narrative and homiletical material (aggadah) that expands on biblical narratives.

- □ **The Targums — Onkelos; Jonathan:** Aramaic translations of the Hebrew Bible, produced for congregational and study use after Aramaic replaced Hebrew as the everyday language of many Jewish communities. They combine translation with interpretive additions.
- □ **Rashi — Commentary on the Torah and Talmud:** Rashi (Rabbi Shlomo Yitzchaki, 1040-1105) was a French rabbi whose commentaries on the Hebrew Bible and Talmud provide explanations of difficult passages, drawing on earlier rabbinic sources. They are printed alongside the base texts in standard editions.
- □ **Moses Maimonides — The Mishneh Torah; the Thirteen Principles of Faith:** Maimonides (1138-1204) was a rabbi, philosopher, and physician. The Mishneh Torah is a comprehensive code organizing Jewish law by topic; the Thirteen Principles summarize core tenets of Jewish belief, formulated in his commentary on the Mishnah.
- □ **Joseph Karo — The Shulchan Aruch:** A sixteenth-century code of Jewish law compiled by Joseph Karo, organized by topic and covering daily religious practice, festivals, and personal and civil law. It became a standard legal reference, supplemented by later glosses reflecting Ashkenazi custom.
- □ **Saadia Gaon — The Book of Beliefs and Opinions:** Saadia Gaon (882-942), head of the Sura academy in Babylonia, wrote this work of Jewish philosophy in Arabic, addressing the relationship between reason and revelation and defending Jewish doctrine using philosophical argument.
- □ **Judah Halevi — The Kuzari:** A twelfth-century philosophical dialogue in which a king of the Khazars questions representatives of philosophy, Christianity, Islam, and Judaism before adopting Judaism. Halevi presents Jewish revelation and historical experience as a distinct form of knowledge.
- □ **Bahya ibn Paquda — Duties of the Heart:** An eleventh-century work of Jewish ethics, written in Arabic, distinguishing between the "duties of the limbs" (external observance) and the "duties of the heart" (internal states such as humility, trust, and sincerity).
- □ **Sefer ha-Bahir (The Book of Brightness):** An early Kabbalistic text, appearing in the twelfth century, presenting concepts including the sefirot (divine emanations) and the transmigration of souls in a cryptic, symbolic style.
- □ **Abraham Abulafia — The Light of the Intellect:** Abulafia (1240-c. 1291) developed a form of Kabbalah involving meditative techniques based on combinations of Hebrew letters and divine names, aimed at inducing prophetic or ecstatic states.
- □ **Joseph Gikatilla — Gates of Light:** A thirteenth-century Kabbalistic text by Joseph Gikatilla explaining the ten sefirot and their associated divine names, intended as an introductory guide to Kabbalistic symbolism.
- □ **Moses Cordovero — Pardes Rimonim:** A sixteenth-century systematic treatise by the Safed Kabbalist Moses Cordovero, organizing earlier Kabbalistic teachings, particularly concerning the sefirot, into a structured theological framework.
- □ **Isaac Luria & Chaim Vital — Etz Chaim (The Tree of Life):** Records the teachings of Isaac Luria (1534-1572), a Kabbalist active in Safed, as compiled by his student Chaim Vital. Central concepts include tzimtzum (divine self-contraction), the breaking of the vessels, and tikkun (repair), describing the process of creation and its restoration.
- □ **Moses Chaim Luzzatto — The Path of the Just (Mesillat Yesharim):** An eighteenth-century Italian work of Jewish ethics describing stages of moral and spiritual development, from care in observance to piety and holiness, drawing on earlier rabbinic sources including Pirkei Avot.
- □ **Sefer Raziel HaMalakh:** A compilation of Kabbalistic, angelological, and magical material, traditionally attributed to the angel Raziel, including material on amulets and cosmology, circulated from the medieval period onward.

- ☐ **The Passover Haggadah:** The text recited during the Passover seder, recounting the biblical account of the Exodus from Egypt and structuring the ritual meal, including prescribed blessings, questions, and readings.
- ☐ **Nachman of Breslov — Likutei Moharan; The Tales:** Nachman of Breslov (1772-1810) was a Hasidic rabbi. Likutei Moharan collects his teachings and discourses; his tales are a series of allegorical stories addressing themes of faith and struggle, recorded by his followers.
- ☐ **Martin Buber — I and Thou:** A 1923 philosophical work by Martin Buber distinguishing between two modes of relation: "I-It," oriented toward use and objectification, and "I-Thou," a direct and reciprocal relation, which Buber extends to relation with God.
- ☐ **Abraham Joshua Heschel — The Sabbath; God in Search of Man:** Heschel (1907-1972) was a rabbi and theologian. The Sabbath discusses the Jewish observance of the Sabbath as a structuring of time; God in Search of Man presents his approach to Jewish theology and the concept of divine pathos.
- ☐ **The Mu'allaqat (The Seven Hanging Odes):** A collection of seven (in some versions ten) pre-Islamic Arabic odes (qasidas), attributed to poets including Imru' al-Qais and Antarah ibn Shaddad. Tradition holds they were displayed at the Kaaba in Mecca; their themes include desert life, tribal honor, and lost love.
- ☐ **Antarah ibn Shaddad — Diwan; Sirat Antar:** Antarah was a pre-Islamic poet-warrior, son of an Arab father and an enslaved Ethiopian mother, known for verses on love and battle addressed to his beloved Abila. The Sirat Antar is a later popular romance elaborating his life into an extended chivalric narrative.
- ☐ **Abu Nuwas — Diwan:** An Abbasid-era poet (c. 756-814) known for verse on wine and love, as well as satire and hunting poems, associated with the court culture of Baghdad. His work departed from the conventions of earlier Arabic poetry.
- ☐ **Al-Mutanabbi — Diwan:** A tenth-century Arabic poet (915-965) known for panegyric and self-praise poetry composed for various rulers and patrons. His verse is frequently cited in later Arabic literary and rhetorical tradition.
- ☐ **Abu al-Ala al-Ma'arri — The Epistle of Forgiveness; Luzumiyyat:** Al-Ma'arri (973-1057) was a blind Syrian poet and writer. The Epistle of Forgiveness depicts a journey through the afterlife and has been compared to Dante's Divine Comedy; the Luzumiyyat is a poetry collection expressing skeptical and ascetic views, including criticism of organized religion.
- ☐ **Ibn al-Muqaffa — Kalila wa Dimna:** An eighth-century Arabic adaptation, by Ibn al-Muqaffa, of Indian animal fables originating in the Sanskrit Panchatantra, concerning statecraft and ethics, told through the interactions of animal characters. It was translated into numerous languages in subsequent centuries.
- ☐ **Al-Hariri — The Maqamat:** A collection of fifty narrative episodes composed by al-Hariri of Basra (1054-1122) in rhymed prose (saj') featuring a recurring eloquent and roguish protagonist. The maqamat form emphasizes linguistic virtuosity and wordplay.
- ☐ **Usama ibn Munqidh — The Book of Contemplation:** A memoir by a twelfth-century Syrian nobleman and warrior describing his experiences during the Crusades, including encounters with Frankish crusaders, alongside accounts of hunting and court life.
- ☐ **Sahih al-Bukhari (a selection):** A ninth-century collection of hadith (reports of the sayings and actions of Muhammad) compiled by Muhammad al-Bukhari, organized by subject and evaluated for the reliability of their chains of transmission (isnad). It is regarded by Sunni Muslims as one of the most authoritative hadith collections.
- ☐ **Sahih Muslim:** A hadith collection compiled by Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj in the ninth century, regarded alongside Sahih al-Bukhari as one of the two collections given the highest degree of authority in Sunni Islam.

- □ **Ibn Ishaq / Ibn Hisham — The Life of Muhammad (Sirat Rasul Allah):** An eighth-century biography of Muhammad by Ibn Ishaq, surviving in a recension by Ibn Hisham, covering his life, the early revelations, the emigration to Medina, and the establishment of the Muslim community. It is among the earliest extant biographical accounts of Muhammad.
- □ **Al-Tabari — History of the Prophets and Kings:** A universal history by the ninth/tenth-century scholar al-Tabari, covering events from creation through the author's own time, including pre-Islamic history and the early Islamic period, compiled from earlier sources and oral traditions.
- □ **Ferdowsi — The Shahnameh (The Book of Kings):** An epic poem completed around 1010 AD by the Persian poet Ferdowsi, comprising approximately 50,000 couplets recounting the mythical and historical history of Iran from creation to the Arab conquest in the 7th century. It is written in New Persian and includes the story of the hero Rostam.
- □ **Rudaki — Diwan:** Rudaki (c. 858-941) is regarded as one of the earliest major poets writing in New Persian, active at the Samanid court in Bukhara. Only fragments of his extensive body of work survive.
- □ **Sanai — The Walled Garden of Truth:** A twelfth-century Persian poem by Sanai of Ghazna, generally considered among the earliest major works to use the Persian masnavi (rhyming couplet) form for extended Sufi religious instruction, combining doctrine, parable, and homily.
- □ **Nizami Ganjavi — The Khamsa (Layla and Majnun; Khosrow and Shirin; The Seven Beauties):** A collection of five narrative poems composed in the twelfth century by Nizami, including Layla and Majnun (the story of ill-fated lovers), Khosrow and Shirin, and The Seven Beauties (Haft Paykar). The poems combine romance with historical and legendary material.
- □ **Saadi — The Gulistan; The Bustan:** Saadi of Shiraz (c. 1210-1291/94) wrote the Gulistan, a work mixing prose and verse offering anecdotes and moral reflections, and the Bustan, a poem on ethical and social topics. Both address themes such as justice, contentment, and love.
- □ **Hafiz — The Divan:** A collection of ghazals (lyric poems) by the fourteenth-century Persian poet Hafiz of Shiraz, addressing themes of love, wine, and mysticism, often read with both literal and allegorical interpretations. His collected Divan is widely printed and used in Iran for a traditional practice of divination (fal-e Hafez).
- □ **Jami — Yusuf and Zulaikha; Haft Awrang:** Jami (1414-1492) was a Persian poet and Sufi scholar, often regarded as among the last of the major classical Persian poets. Yusuf and Zulaikha retells the biblical/Quranic story of Joseph as a Sufi allegory of love; Haft Awrang ("Seven Thrones") is a collection of seven narrative poems.
- □ **Al-Kindi — On First Philosophy:** Al-Kindi (c. 801-873), known as "the philosopher of the Arabs," was among the first to systematically incorporate Greek philosophical concepts into Arabic-language Islamic thought. On First Philosophy addresses metaphysics and argues for the compatibility of philosophy with Islamic doctrine.
- □ **Al-Farabi — The Virtuous City:** Al-Farabi (c. 872-950), known in the later Islamic tradition as "the second teacher" after Aristotle, wrote on logic, metaphysics, and political philosophy. The Virtuous City (al-Madina al-Fadila) describes an ideal state modeled partly on Platonic political philosophy, led by a philosopher-prophet figure.
- □ **Avicenna (Ibn Sina) — The Book of Healing; The Canon of Medicine:** Ibn Sina (980-1037) was a philosopher and physician. The Canon of Medicine is a systematic medical encyclopedia used as a standard reference in Europe and the Islamic world for several centuries; The Book of Healing addresses logic, natural science, and metaphysics, including his distinction between necessary and contingent existence.
- □ **Suhrawardi — The Philosophy of Illumination:** Shihab al-Din Suhrawardi (1154-1191) founded the Illuminationist (Ishraqi) school of Islamic philosophy, presenting a metaphysics organized around degrees of light emanating from a "Light of Lights," drawing on Platonic and Zoroastrian sources. He was executed in Aleppo.

- □ **Ibn Arabi — The Bezels of Wisdom; The Meccan Revelations:** Ibn Arabi (1165-1240) was an Andalusian Sufi philosopher known for the doctrine of *wahdat al-wujud* (the unity of being). *The Bezels of Wisdom* (*Fusus al-Hikam*) discusses the spiritual character of successive prophets; *The Meccan Revelations* (*al-Futuhāt al-Makkiyya*) is an extensive compendium of his mystical and philosophical teachings.
- □ **Omar Khayyam — Treatise on Algebra:** Omar Khayyam (1048-1131), better known in the West for his quatrains (the *Rubaiyat*), was also a mathematician and astronomer. His algebraic treatise classifies and provides geometric solutions to cubic equations; he also contributed to the reform of the Persian solar calendar.
- □ **Al-Jahiz — The Book of Animals; The Book of Misers:** Al-Jahiz (c. 776-868) was an Abbasid-era prose writer. *The Book of Animals* is a wide-ranging compilation combining zoological material with anecdote and digression; *The Book of Misers* collects satirical anecdotes about miserly behavior.
- □ **Al-Masudi — The Meadows of Gold:** Al-Masudi (c. 896-956) was a historian and geographer. *The Meadows of Gold* is a wide-ranging work combining history, geography, and anecdote drawn from his travels and reading, covering regions from the Islamic world to India and beyond.
- □ **Rabia al-Adawiyya — Poems and Sayings:** Rabia al-Adawiyya (c. 717-801) was an early female Sufi figure from Basra, associated with the teaching that God should be loved for God's own sake, without hope of reward or fear of punishment. Her sayings survive primarily through later biographical and hagiographical sources.
- □ **Al-Hallaj — The Tawasin; the poems:** Al-Hallaj (858-922) was a Sufi mystic executed in Baghdad, reportedly in part for the statement "*ana al-Haqq*" ("I am the Truth"), interpreted as a claim of mystical union with God. *The Tawasin* is a collection of his prose and poetic writings.
- □ **Nasir Khusraw — Diwan; Safarnama:** Nasir Khusraw (1004-1088) was a Persian poet, philosopher, and Ismaili missionary. *The Safarnama* recounts a seven-year journey he made to Mecca, Cairo, and other regions; his *Diwan* addresses ethical and religious themes.

Module 10: India, China, and Japan

About 20.5 hours of reading and 1.1 hours of survey.

The Upanishads and the Gita, the Buddha's teaching and its development into Zen, and the Confucian and Daoist classics. The passages are short, and many are meant to be reread slowly.

What to take away

- The Upanishads teach that atman (the self) is brahman (ultimate reality). The Gita teaches action without attachment to its results.
- The Buddha teaches suffering, its cause, its end, and the path, and denies a permanent self (anatta). Mahayana and Zen develop this into emptiness and direct insight.
- Confucius grounds order in ritual, family, and cultivated character. Laozi and Zhuangzi turn to spontaneity and the Way.

Read

1. ☐ **The Principal Upanishads — Isha, Katha, Kena, Mundaka, Chandogya, Brihadaranyaka** (~2 h)

Read: Isha, Katha, and Chandogya VI ('tat tvam asi').

Edition: Tr. Patrick Olivelle, Upanisads (Oxford World's Classics); or Eknath Easwaran (Nilgiri)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

2. ☐ **The Bhagavad Gita** (~4 h)

Read: The whole text.

Edition: Tr. Laurie Patton (Penguin) or Eknath Easwaran (Nilgiri)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

3. ☐ **The Pali Canon (Tipitaka) — the Digha and Majjhima Nikayas** (~2 h)

Read: Majjhima Nikaya 22 (the raft) and 63 (the poisoned arrow).

Edition: Tr. Bhikkhu Nanamoli and Bhikkhu Bodhi, The Middle Length Discourses (Wisdom); Maurice Walshe, The Long Discourses (Wisdom); Bhikkhu Bodhi, In the Buddha's Words (Wisdom) as an anthology; free at SuttaCentral

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [SuttaCentral](#)

4. ☐ **The Dhammapada** (~1 h)

Read: Chapters 1-5.

Edition: Tr. Gil Fronsdal (Shambhala) or Valerie Roebuck (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

5. ☐ **The Heart Sutra** (~0.5 h)

Read: The whole text, one page.

Edition: Red Pine, The Heart Sutra (Counterpoint); or in Edward Conze, Buddhist Wisdom Books (Allen & Unwin)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [SuttaCentral](#)

6. ☐ **Confucius — The Analects** (~2 h)

Read: Books 1, 2, 4, 12, and 15.

Edition: Tr. Edward Slingerland (Hackett) or D.C. Lau (Penguin); free at Chinese Text Project (Legge)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

7. ☐ **Mencius — The Mencius** (~1 h)

Read: 2A6 (the four sprouts) and 6A1-8 (human nature).

Edition: Tr. Bryan Van Norden (Hackett) or D.C. Lau (Penguin); free at Chinese Text Project (Legge)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

8. ☐ **Laozi — Tao Te Ching** (~1.5 h)

Read: The whole text.

Edition: Tr. D.C. Lau (Penguin) and Stephen Addiss and Stanley Lombardo (Hackett); compare two

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

9. ☐ **Zhuangzi — The Zhuangzi** (~1.5 h)

Read: Chapters 1-3, including the butterfly dream and Cook Ding.

Edition: Tr. Burton Watson, The Complete Works of Zhuangzi (Columbia); or Brook Ziporyn (Hackett)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

10. ☐ **Sun Tzu — The Art of War** (~2 h)

Read: The whole text.

Edition: Tr. Samuel B. Griffith (Oxford) or Victor Mair (Columbia)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

11. ☐ **Huineng — The Platform Sutra of the Sixth Patriarch** (~1 h)

Read: The autobiographical opening and the verse contest.

Edition: Tr. Philip Yampolsky, The Platform Sutra of the Sixth Patriarch (Columbia); or Red Pine (Counterpoint)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [SuttaCentral](#)

12. ☐ **Anon. — The Gateless Gate (Mumonkan)** (~1 h)

Read: Cases 1-10.

Edition: Tr. Koun Yamada, The Gateless Gate (Wisdom)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [SuttaCentral](#)

13. ☐ **Matsuo Basho — The Narrow Road to the Deep North** (~1 h)

Read: The opening and the Hiraizumi passage.

Edition: Tr. Sam Hamill (Shambhala) or Nobuyuki Yuasa (Penguin)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [Chinese Text Project](#)

Check yourself. Compare Krishna's advice to Arjuna with Epictetus's Enchiridion.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Yamamoto Tsunetomo — Hagakure:** A collection of commentaries on the way of the samurai compiled in the early 18th century by Tashiro Tsuramoto, based on the sayings of the retired samurai Yamamoto Tsunetomo. Composed during a period of relative peace in Japan, it discusses loyalty, duty, and the acceptance of death as elements of samurai ethics. It was not widely circulated until the 20th century.
- ☐ **Miyamoto Musashi — The Book of Five Rings:** A treatise on strategy and swordsmanship written around 1645 by the Japanese swordsman Miyamoto Musashi, shortly before his death. It is organized into five sections (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind, and Void), addressing technique, timing, and psychology in combat. It is studied in martial arts contexts and, in later reception, as a text on strategy more broadly.

- ☐ **The I Ching (Book of Changes):** An ancient Chinese divination text, with its core layer dating to around the 9th century BC and later philosophical commentaries (the "Ten Wings") added over subsequent centuries. It is structured around sixty-four hexagrams, each composed of six broken or unbroken lines, used to interpret situations and guide decisions. It has also been read as a philosophical work addressing change and the interaction of yin and yang.
- ☐ **Inazo Nitobe — Bushido: The Soul of Japan:** A book written in English and published in 1900 by the Japanese educator and diplomat Inazo Nitobe, intended to explain samurai ethical principles to a Western readership. It presents bushido as a code comparable to European chivalry, covering virtues such as loyalty, honor, and self-control. It was influential in shaping early 20th-century Western perceptions of Japanese culture.
- ☐ **Anon. — The Tale of the Heike:** A Japanese epic recounting the conflict between the Taira and Minamoto clans in the late 12th century, compiled from oral traditions and likely reaching its written form in the 13th-14th centuries. Its opening passage reflects Buddhist themes of impermanence, applied to the fall of the Taira clan. It was traditionally recited by itinerant biwa-playing performers.
- ☐ **Murasaki Shikibu — The Tale of Genji:** A work of Japanese prose fiction written in the early 11th century by Murasaki Shikibu, a lady of the Heian court. It follows the life and romantic relationships of Genji, the son of an emperor, and later generations of his family, depicting the customs and aesthetics of Heian court society. It is often cited as one of the earliest surviving novels.
- ☐ **The Kojiki:** The oldest extant chronicle of Japan, compiled in 712 AD, recording mythological accounts of the creation of Japan and its gods alongside a genealogy of the early imperial line. It is a primary source for Shinto mythology and early Japanese history.
- ☐ **Vyasa (attrib.) — The Mahabharata:** One of the two major Sanskrit epics of ancient India, traditionally attributed to the sage Vyasa, with its core narrative developed between roughly the 4th century BC and 4th century AD. It recounts the conflict between the Kaurava and Pandava branches of a royal family, culminating in the Kurukshetra War, and includes the Bhagavad Gita as one episode. At around 100,000 verses, it is one of the longest epic poems known.
- ☐ **Valmiki — The Ramayana:** A Sanskrit epic traditionally attributed to the sage Valmiki, with its core composed roughly between the 5th century BC and 1st century AD. It narrates the exile of Prince Rama, the abduction of his wife Sita by the demon king Ravana, and the war waged to recover her. It holds significant religious and cultural status across South and Southeast Asia.
- ☐ **Omar Khayyam — The Rubaiyat:** A collection of quatrains (rubaiyat) attributed to the Persian polymath Omar Khayyam (1048-1131), addressing themes of mortality, fate, and the pleasures of the present moment. The attribution and authenticity of many individual verses are disputed among scholars. It became widely known in English through Edward FitzGerald's 1859 translation, which adapted rather than literally rendered the original Persian.
- ☐ **Anon. — The Thousand and One Nights:** A collection of Middle Eastern and South Asian folk tales compiled over several centuries, framed by the story of Scheherazade, who delays her execution by telling her husband, the king, a continuing series of stories. Tales including those of Aladdin and Sinbad the Sailor were added to the collection in later European translations. It draws on Persian, Arabic, and Indian narrative traditions.
- ☐ **The Four Books — The Great Learning; The Doctrine of the Mean:** Two short texts, originally chapters of the Book of Rites, later compiled with the Analects and the Mencius into the "Four Books" of Confucianism by the Song-dynasty scholar Zhu Xi. They address self-cultivation, moral development, and the relationship between the individual and the well-ordered state. The Four Books formed the basis of the Chinese imperial civil service examination curriculum for several centuries.

- ☐ **Sei Shonagon — The Pillow Book:** A collection of observations, lists, and anecdotes written around 1000 AD by Sei Shonagon, a lady-in-waiting at the Japanese imperial court during the Heian period. It combines diary-like entries with categorized lists of impressions and preferences. It is considered an early example of the *zuihitsu* ("following the brush") genre of Japanese literature.
- ☐ **Kenko — Essays in Idleness (Tsurezuregusa):** A collection of essays written by the Buddhist monk Yoshida Kenko around 1330-1332, covering topics including aesthetics, impermanence, and observations on daily life. Written in the *zuihitsu* style, its short, loosely connected sections cover a wide range of subjects. It is considered a significant work of medieval Japanese literature.
- ☐ **Kakuzo Okakura — The Book of Tea:** A short book written in English and published in 1906 by the Japanese scholar Kakuzo Okakura, explaining the aesthetic and philosophical principles behind the Japanese tea ceremony to Western readers. It discusses the influence of Zen Buddhism and Taoism on Japanese approaches to art and daily life. It was written partly in response to Western misunderstandings of Japanese culture at the time.
- ☐ **The Shijing (The Book of Songs):** The oldest surviving collection of Chinese poetry, comprising 305 poems dating from roughly the 11th to 7th centuries BC. It includes folk songs, court poems, and ceremonial hymns, and was traditionally said to have been edited by Confucius. It became one of the Five Classics of the Confucian canon.
- ☐ **Qu Yuan — The Songs of Chu (Li Sao):** A collection of poems associated with the statesman and poet Qu Yuan (c. 340-278 BC) of the state of Chu, along with later additions by other poets. Qu Yuan is traditionally said to have drowned himself after being exiled on charges of disloyalty. The Dragon Boat Festival is traditionally linked to his death.
- ☐ **Tao Yuanming — Collected Poems:** The poetry of Tao Yuanming (also known as Tao Qian, 365-427 AD), a Chinese official who retired from government service to live as a farmer. His verse depicts rural life, wine, and contentment with a simple existence, often centered on imagery of chrysanthemums and the countryside. He is regarded as an early and influential figure in Chinese nature poetry.
- ☐ **Li Bai (Li Po) — Poems:** The poetry of Li Bai (701-762 AD), a Tang-dynasty poet known for verse on themes of nature, friendship, and wine. His work is associated with the high point of Tang-dynasty poetry and is often discussed alongside that of his contemporary Du Fu. Roughly a thousand of his poems survive.
- ☐ **Du Fu (Tu Fu) — Poems:** The poetry of Du Fu (712-770 AD), a contemporary of Li Bai, whose verse addresses war, social hardship, and personal loss during a period of upheaval in the Tang dynasty, including the An Lushan Rebellion. His detailed, historically grounded style earned him the traditional epithet "poet-historian." Over 1,400 of his poems survive.
- ☐ **Wang Wei — Poems:** The poetry of Wang Wei (699-759 AD), a Tang-dynasty poet, painter, and government official known for landscape poetry influenced by Buddhist contemplation. His verse frequently depicts natural scenes with an emphasis on stillness and quiet observation. He was also a noted landscape painter, and later critics linked the two aspects of his work.
- ☐ **The Rigveda (the Vedic hymns):** A collection of Sanskrit hymns composed over a period beginning around the second millennium BC, addressed to deities such as Agni, Indra, and Varuna. It is the oldest of the four Vedas and has been transmitted through oral recitation techniques designed to preserve its exact wording.
- ☐ **Patanjali — The Yoga Sutras:** A Sanskrit text, compiled around the early centuries AD, presenting a systematic account of yoga as a discipline for stilling mental activity. It describes eight limbs (*ashtanga*) of practice, including ethical observances, posture, breath control, and meditative absorption.

- ☐ **Adi Shankara — Crest-Jewel of Discrimination; the Upanishad commentaries:** Adi Shankara (traditionally dated to the 8th century AD) was a philosopher associated with the Advaita (non-dualist) school of Vedanta, holding that Brahman alone is ultimately real and that the perceived world of multiplicity is due to ignorance (avidya). He wrote commentaries on the Upanishads, the Brahma Sutras, and the Bhagavad Gita.
- ☐ **The Laws of Manu (Manusmriti):** A Sanskrit legal and religious text, compiled roughly between the 2nd century BC and 2nd century AD, addressing social duty (dharma) organized by caste (varna) and stage of life (ashrama), along with cosmology and ritual matters. It has been an influential, and in the modern period a debated, text in the history of Hindu law.
- ☐ **Kautilya — The Arthashastra:** A Sanskrit treatise on statecraft, economics, and military strategy, traditionally attributed to Kautilya (also known as Chanakya), a minister associated with the Maurya court around the 4th century BC, though its final compilation may be later. It addresses administration, taxation, diplomacy, and espionage.
- ☐ **Kalidasa — Shakuntala; The Cloud Messenger; The Birth of Kumara:** Kalidasa (active c. 4th-5th century AD) was a Sanskrit poet and dramatist. Shakuntala (Abhijnanashakuntalam) is a play recounting the love story of King Dushyanta and Shakuntala; The Cloud Messenger (Meghaduta) is a lyric poem in which an exiled figure sends a message via a cloud; The Birth of Kumara (Kumarasambhava) narrates the birth of the god Kartikeya.
- ☐ **The Panchatantra:** A Sanskrit collection of interlinked animal fables, compiled in its earliest known form around the 3rd century AD, intended to instruct princes in practical wisdom and statecraft. It was widely translated and adapted, including as the Arabic Kalila wa Dimna.
- ☐ **Bhartrhari — The Three Centuries (Shatakatraya):** A collection of Sanskrit epigrams attributed to Bhartrhari (dates uncertain, possibly 5th century AD), traditionally divided into three sets of roughly one hundred verses each, on worldly conduct, love, and renunciation.
- ☐ **Jayadeva — The Gitagovinda:** A twelfth-century Sanskrit lyric poem by Jayadeva describing the love of the god Krishna and the cowherd Radha. It has been read both as erotic poetry and as religious allegory and has influenced later devotional literature, music, and dance traditions.
- ☐ **Rabindranath Tagore — Gitanjali; The Home and the World; selected poems:** Tagore (1861-1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and composer. Gitanjali ("Song Offerings") is a collection of devotional poems for which he received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913, the first non-European recipient of the prize; The Home and the World is a novel addressing nationalism and personal relationships set during the Swadeshi movement.
- ☐ **Tiruvalluvar — Tirukkural:** A Tamil text of couplets, of uncertain date (estimates range from roughly the 1st century BC to the 5th century AD), traditionally attributed to Tiruvalluvar, addressing virtue (aram), wealth and governance (porul), and love (inbam).
- ☐ **Sudraka — The Little Clay Cart (Mrcchakatika):** A Sanskrit drama traditionally attributed to a king or author named Sudraka, of uncertain date (estimates range from around the 2nd century BC to the 5th century AD), depicting the relationship between an impoverished merchant, Charudatta, and a courtesan, Vasantasena, against a backdrop of political intrigue.
- ☐ **Tulsidas — Ramcharitmanas:** A sixteenth-century retelling of the Ramayana in Awadhi (a dialect of Hindi) by the poet Tulsidas, presenting the story of Rama within a devotional (bhakti) framework. It is widely read and performed in northern India, including in the annual Ramlila dramatic tradition.
- ☐ **Kabir — Poems (the Bijak; the dohas):** Kabir (traditionally dated to around the 15th century) was a North Indian poet-saint associated with the bhakti and Sant traditions, whose verses, preserved in collections such as the Bijak, criticize ritual formalism in both Hindu and Muslim practice and emphasize direct devotion to a formless God (nirguna).

- □ **Takuan Soho — The Unfettered Mind:** A collection of letters written in the early 17th century by the Zen monk Takuan Sōhō to the swordsman Yagyū Munenori. It discusses the concept of an unfettered, non-abiding mind and its application to swordsmanship. The work connects Zen Buddhist ideas of mindlessness with martial arts training.
- □ **Yagyū Munenori — The Life-Giving Sword (Heiho Kadensho):** A treatise on swordsmanship written in 1632 by Yagyū Munenori, sword instructor to the Tokugawa shoguns. It discusses technique alongside Zen-influenced concepts of perception, timing, and the mental state of the swordsman. It is a foundational text of the Yagyū Shinkage-ryū school of swordsmanship.
- □ **Bodhidharma — The Two Entrances and Four Practices; The Bloodstream Sermon:** Texts attributed to Bodhidharma, a monk traditionally credited with transmitting Chan (Zen) Buddhism from India to China in the 5th or 6th century. They describe entering the Buddhist path through principle and through practice, emphasizing direct insight into one's nature over reliance on scripture. Bodhidharma is traditionally regarded as the first patriarch of Chan Buddhism and is associated with the Shaolin Monastery.
- □ **Dogen — Shobogenzo; Fukanzazengi:** Writings by Dōgen, the 13th-century Japanese monk who founded the Sōtō school of Zen Buddhism. The Shōbōgenzō is a multi-volume collection of essays on Zen practice and philosophy; the Fukanzazengi is a short manual on the practice of seated meditation (zazen). Dōgen taught that meditation practice and enlightenment are not separate.
- □ **Yuanwu — The Blue Cliff Record (Hekiganroku):** A collection of one hundred koans with commentary, compiled in 12th-century China by the Chan master Yuanwu Keqin, based on earlier selections by Xuedou Zhongxian. It combines case narratives, verse commentary, and prose commentary. It is used as a teaching text in the Rinzai Zen tradition.
- □ **Hakuin — Wild Ivy; the koan teachings:** Writings including the spiritual autobiography of Hakuin Ekaku, an 18th-century Japanese monk who revived the Rinzai school of Zen. He developed new koans, including the well-known "what is the sound of one hand clapping," and reorganized koan training. Wild Ivy recounts his meditative experiences and periods of illness and doubt.
- □ **Eugen Herrigel — Zen in the Art of Archery:** A 1948 memoir by the German philosopher Eugen Herrigel describing his study of Japanese archery (kyūdō) under a Zen-influenced teacher in the 1920s. It describes the practice of shooting without deliberate aiming or self-conscious effort. It became a widely read introduction to Zen concepts for Western readers.
- □ **D.T. Suzuki — Zen and Japanese Culture:** A study by the scholar D.T. Suzuki examining the influence of Zen Buddhism on Japanese art forms, including swordsmanship, tea ceremony, haiku, and garden design. First published in expanded form in 1959. Suzuki's writings introduced Zen concepts to a wide English-speaking readership in the 20th century.
- □ **Shunryu Suzuki — Zen Mind, Beginner's Mind:** A 1970 collection of talks by Shunryū Suzuki, a Sōtō Zen priest who founded the San Francisco Zen Center. It presents basic Zen practice and attitudes toward meditation for a general audience, including the phrase "beginner's mind." It is widely used as an introductory text on Zen practice in the West.
- □ **The Diamond Sutra:** A Mahayana Buddhist sutra in the Prajnaparamita (perfection of wisdom) genre, presented as a dialogue between the Buddha and his disciple Subhuti. It addresses the nature of emptiness and non-attachment, including to Buddhist concepts and teachings themselves. A Chinese translation dated 868 CE is the earliest known dated printed book.

- ☐ **The Lotus Sutra:** A Mahayana Buddhist sutra composed roughly between the 1st century BCE and 2nd century CE, teaching that all beings are capable of attaining buddhahood. It uses parables, including that of a father luring children from a burning house, to illustrate the Buddha's use of skillful means (upaya). It has been particularly influential in East Asian Buddhist traditions, including Tiantai and Nichiren Buddhism.
- ☐ **The Vimalakirti Sutra:** A Mahayana sutra in which the layman Vimalakīrti debates Buddhist doctrine with bodhisattvas and disciples of the Buddha. A key passage has Vimalakīrti respond to a question about non-duality with silence. The text emphasizes that lay practitioners can attain deep spiritual realization.
- ☐ **The Lankavatara Sutra:** A Mahayana sutra addressing the doctrine that phenomena are manifestations of mind (cittamatra, or "mind-only"). It was influential in early Chinese Chan Buddhism and is associated with the transmission of Zen from Bodhidharma. It discusses perception, consciousness, and the nature of reality.
- ☐ **Nagarjuna — The Fundamental Verses on the Middle Way:** A philosophical text by Nāgārjuna, a 2nd-century Indian Buddhist philosopher, composed in verse. It develops the concept of emptiness (śūnyatā) through logical analysis, arguing against both inherent existence and nihilism. Nāgārjuna is regarded as the founder of the Madhyamaka ("Middle Way") school of Mahayana Buddhist philosophy.
- ☐ **Shantideva — The Way of the Bodhisattva:** A verse text by the 8th-century Indian monk Śāntideva describing the path and practices of a bodhisattva, one who vows to attain enlightenment for the benefit of all beings. It includes chapters on patience, diligence, meditation, and wisdom. It remains a widely studied text in Mahayana and Vajrayana Buddhism.
- ☐ **The Sutta Nipata; The Udana:** Two texts included in the Khuddaka Nikaya of the Pali Canon, considered among its oldest strata. The Sutta Nipāta is a collection of verse discourses, and the Udāna is a collection of the Buddha's inspired utterances paired with narrative context. Both are associated with early Theravada Buddhist teaching.
- ☐ **Buddhaghosa — The Visuddhimagga (The Path of Purification):** A comprehensive manual of Theravada Buddhist doctrine and meditation practice, composed in Pali by the 5th-century scholar-monk Buddhaghosa in Sri Lanka. It organizes the path to liberation into stages of ethical conduct, concentration, and wisdom. It remains an authoritative reference text in the Theravada tradition.
- ☐ **The Milindapanha (The Questions of King Milinda):** A text presenting a dialogue between the Indo-Greek king Menander I (Milinda) and the Buddhist monk Nagasena, likely composed in the early centuries CE. It addresses questions of Buddhist doctrine, including the nature of the self and rebirth, using the analogy of a chariot to illustrate the concept of no-self (anatta). It is regarded as a significant text in Theravada Buddhist literature.
- ☐ **The Jataka Tales:** A collection of several hundred stories describing the previous lives of the Buddha, included in the Pali Canon's Khuddaka Nikaya. Each tale illustrates a moral or virtue associated with the bodhisattva path. The stories have also circulated widely as folk literature across South and Southeast Asia.
- ☐ **The Tibetan Book of the Dead (Bardo Thodol):** A Tibetan Buddhist text traditionally attributed to Padmasambhava and said to be discovered in the 14th century by Karma Lingpa, used as a guide for the dying and recently deceased. It describes the intermediate state (bardo) between death and rebirth and practices for recognizing the nature of mind during this period. It was first translated into English in 1927 by Walter Evans-Wentz.
- ☐ **The Life of Milarepa; The Hundred Thousand Songs:** Texts recounting the life and teachings of Milarepa, an 11th-12th century Tibetan yogi of the Kagyu lineage. The biography describes his early practice of sorcery, subsequent remorse, and ascetic training under his teacher Marpa; the songs record his spontaneous verse teachings. He is a widely known figure in Tibetan Buddhist literature.

- ☐ **Gampopa — The Jewel Ornament of Liberation:** A systematic exposition of the Buddhist path composed by Gampopa, a 12th-century disciple of Milarepa who integrated monastic and yogic traditions. It presents stages of practice from initial motivation through to buddhahood. It is a foundational text of the Kagyu school of Tibetan Buddhism.
- ☐ **Patrul Rinpoche — The Words of My Perfect Teacher:** A 19th-century manual of the preliminary practices (ngöndro) of the Nyingma school of Tibetan Buddhism, written by Patrul Rinpoche. It combines doctrinal instruction with stories and anecdotes. It remains widely used as an introductory text in Nyingma and Dzogchen practice.
- ☐ **Tsongkhapa — The Great Treatise on the Stages of the Path (Lamrim Chenmo):** A systematic presentation of the Buddhist path to enlightenment composed in 1402 by Tsongkhapa, founder of the Gelug school of Tibetan Buddhism. It organizes teachings into a graduated sequence of stages (lamrim) drawing on Indian Buddhist sources. The Gelug school later became associated with the lineage of the Dalai Lamas.
- ☐ **Ashvaghosha — Buddhacarita (The Life of the Buddha):** An epic poem in Sanskrit recounting the life of the Buddha, composed by the poet Aśvaghōṣa in the 1st or 2nd century CE. It follows Siddhartha Gautama from his birth and sheltered upbringing through renunciation, enlightenment, and teaching. It is among the earliest surviving complete biographies of the Buddha in Sanskrit literature.
- ☐ **The Avatamsaka (Flower Garland) Sutra:** A large Mahayana Buddhist sutra, likely compiled in Central Asia or China by the 4th century CE from earlier component texts. It presents a vision of interpenetrating reality, illustrated by the image of Indra's net, in which each element reflects all others. It became a foundational text of the Huayan school of Chinese Buddhism.
- ☐ **The Surangama Sutra:** A Mahayana Buddhist sutra addressing the nature of mind, perception, and meditative attainment, of disputed origin and possibly composed in China. It discusses various meditative states and the causes of delusion. It was studied within Chan (Zen) Buddhist circles for its treatment of consciousness.
- ☐ **The Record of Linji (Rinzai Roku):** A collection of sayings and sermons attributed to Linji Yixuan, a 9th-century Chinese Chan master and founder of what became known as the Linji (Rinzai) school. It is known for its direct, iconoclastic teaching style, including the instruction to "kill the Buddha" if one is encountered as an obstacle. It is regarded as a foundational text of the Rinzai Zen tradition.

Module 11: Renaissance and the New Science

About 20.5 hours of reading and 0.8 hours of survey.

The recovery of ancient texts, a new political realism, the essay and the stage, and the attempt to rebuild knowledge on new foundations. The science of this period is covered here by survey. The philosophy is read directly.

What to take away

- Renaissance humanism says human beings have no fixed place in creation and must make themselves (Pico).
- Machiavelli and Hobbes ground politics in power and fear rather than in virtue or divine order.
- Descartes starts philosophy over from the thinking self. Locke grounds government in consent and property.

Read

1. ☐ **Pico della Mirandola — Oration on the Dignity of Man; the 900 Theses** (~1 h)

Read: The first part of the Oration, on the dignity of man.

Edition: Ed. Borghesi, Papio and Riva, *Oration on the Dignity of Man: A New Translation and Commentary* (Cambridge)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#) · [ToposText](#)

2. ☐ **Niccolo Machiavelli — The Prince; Discourses on Livy** (~3 h)

Read: The Prince, in full.

Edition: The Prince tr. Harvey Mansfield (Chicago); Discourses tr. Mansfield and Tarcov (Chicago)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

3. ☐ **Michel de Montaigne — Essays** (~2 h)

Read: 'That to philosophize is to learn to die' and 'Of cannibals'.

Edition: Tr. M.A. Screech, *The Complete Essays* (Penguin); or Donald Frame (Stanford)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

4. ☐ **William Shakespeare — The Tragedies and Histories** (~4 h)

Read: Hamlet. Add King Lear if time allows.

Edition: The Arden Shakespeare, Folger Shakespeare Library, or Oxford World's Classics single volumes; Folger texts are free online

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

5. ☐ **Miguel de Cervantes — Don Quixote** (~2 h)

Read: Part I, chapters 1-8, through the windmills.

Edition: Tr. Edith Grossman (Ecco)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

6. ☐ **Rene Descartes — Meditations on First Philosophy; Discourse on Method** (~2 h)

Read: Meditations I-II.

Edition: Tr. John Cottingham, *Meditations on First Philosophy* (Cambridge); Discourse on Method tr. Donald Cress (Hackett)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

7. ☐ **Thomas Hobbes — Leviathan** (~2 h)

Read: Leviathan chapters 13-14 and 17.

Edition: Ed. Edwin Curley (Hackett); or Richard Tuck (Cambridge)

Find it: [Free public-domain text](#) (Gutenberg search) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

8. ☐ **Blaise Pascal — Pensees** (~1 h)

Read: The wager, the two infinities, and the thinking reed.

Edition: Tr. A.J. Krailsheimer, *Pensees* (Penguin), Lafuma numbering

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

9. ☐ **John Milton — Paradise Lost** (~1.5 h)

Read: *Paradise Lost*, Book I.

Edition: Ed. Gordon Teskey (Norton Critical Edition); or John Leonard (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

10. ☐ **John Locke — An Essay Concerning Human Understanding; Two Treatises of Government** (~2 h)

Read: Second Treatise chapters 2, 5, and 9 (the state of nature, property, the ends of government).

Edition: *Two Treatises* ed. Peter Laslett (Cambridge); *Essay* ed. Roger Woolhouse (Penguin)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

Check yourself. How would Hobbes answer Thrasymachus in *Republic I*?

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Benoit Mandelbrot — The Fractal Geometry of Nature; The (Mis)Behavior of Markets:** Works by mathematician Benoit Mandelbrot on fractal geometry, patterns that display self-similarity across different scales. *The Fractal Geometry of Nature* (1982) applies this framework to natural forms such as coastlines and clouds; *The (Mis)Behavior of Markets* (2004) applies related ideas to financial price movements.
- ☐ **Henri Poincare — Science and Hypothesis; The Value of Science:** Essay collections by mathematician and physicist Henri Poincare, published in the early twentieth century, on the philosophy of science. They examine the role of convention, hypothesis, and intuition in mathematics and physics, including reflections on questions later associated with relativity and chaos theory.
- ☐ **D'Arcy Wentworth Thompson — On Growth and Form:** A 1917 book by the Scottish biologist and mathematician D'Arcy Wentworth Thompson, analyzing biological form through physical and mathematical principles. It discusses examples including the logarithmic spiral of shells and the scaling of skeletal structure, arguing that physical forces shape organic growth alongside natural selection.
- ☐ **Galileo Galilei — Dialogue Concerning the Two Chief World Systems:** A 1632 work by Galileo, written as a dialogue among three speakers, comparing the Ptolemaic geocentric and Copernican heliocentric models of the universe. Its advocacy for heliocentrism led to Galileo's trial by the Roman Inquisition. It is regarded as a significant text in the development of the modern scientific method.
- ☐ **Isaac Newton — The Principia:** Published in 1687 as *Philosophiae Naturalis Principia Mathematica*, Newton's treatise formulates the laws of motion and universal gravitation and applies them mathematically to the motion of celestial and terrestrial bodies. It is regarded as a founding work of classical mechanics.
- ☐ **Albert Einstein — Relativity: The Special and the General Theory:** A 1916 popular exposition by Albert Einstein of his special and general theories of relativity, written for readers without advanced training in physics or mathematics. It explains concepts including time dilation, length contraction, and the curvature of spacetime by gravity.

- ☐ **Werner Heisenberg — Physics and Philosophy:** A 1958 book by physicist Werner Heisenberg, a co-founder of quantum mechanics, discussing the philosophical implications of quantum theory. It addresses the uncertainty principle, the role of the observer in measurement, and the relation of quantum physics to earlier philosophical traditions.
- ☐ **Erwin Schrodinger — What Is Life?:** A 1944 book based on lectures by physicist Erwin Schrodinger, examining the physical basis of heredity and biological order from the standpoint of physics. It proposed the idea of an "aperiodic crystal" encoding genetic information, later cited as an influence on the discovery of the structure of DNA.
- ☐ **Richard Feynman — The Character of Physical Law; QED:** Books based on public lectures by physicist Richard Feynman. The Character of Physical Law (1965) discusses the nature of physical laws and the scientific method using examples from gravitation and conservation principles; QED (1985) explains the theory of quantum electrodynamics for a general audience.
- ☐ **James Gleick — Chaos: Making a New Science:** A 1987 popular science book by James Gleick describing the development of chaos theory. It covers topics including the butterfly effect, strange attractors, and fractal geometry, and profiles scientists who contributed to the field in the 1960s and 1970s.
- ☐ **Nicolaus Copernicus — On the Revolutions of the Heavenly Spheres:** Published in 1543, De revolutionibus orbium coelestium by Nicolaus Copernicus proposes a heliocentric model of the solar system, in which the earth and other planets orbit the sun. It is regarded as a starting point of the Copernican Revolution in astronomy.
- ☐ **Johannes Kepler — Astronomia Nova; Harmonices Mundi:** Works by astronomer Johannes Kepler. Astronomia Nova (1609) presents his first two laws of planetary motion, including that planets move in elliptical rather than circular orbits; Harmonices Mundi (1619) presents his third law and explores mathematical and musical proportions he associated with planetary motion.
- ☐ **G.H. Hardy — A Mathematician's Apology:** A 1940 essay by mathematician G.H. Hardy reflecting on the nature and value of mathematics, particularly pure mathematics pursued without practical application. It discusses mathematical aesthetics and the criteria, such as elegance and depth, by which mathematicians judge their work.
- ☐ **Primo Levi — The Periodic Table:** A 1975 memoir by chemist and writer Primo Levi, structured as twenty-one chapters each named after a chemical element. It combines autobiographical episodes, including his imprisonment at Auschwitz, with reflections drawn from his career as an industrial chemist.
- ☐ **Plato — Republic; Laws:** Plato's Republic (4th century BC) constructs an ideal city ruled by philosopher-kings as an analogy for the structure of a just soul. The Laws, a later dialogue, proposes a detailed legal code as the basis of government rather than rule by an individual sage. Both works address questions of justice, education, and the organization of the state.
- ☐ **Aristotle — Politics; The Constitution of Athens:** Aristotle's Politics (4th century BC) classifies forms of government by who holds power and in whose interest it is exercised, and describes humans as naturally social or "political" beings. The Constitution of Athens describes the historical development and structure of the Athenian government. Aristotle favored a mixed constitution with a substantial middle class.
- ☐ **Cicero — On the Republic; On the Laws:** Dialogues by the Roman statesman and philosopher (106-43 BC), modeled on Plato's works, discussing the ideal mixed constitution and the basis of law in nature and reason. Cicero argues that true law is grounded in reason common to gods and humans, rather than in the decrees of rulers. Portions of both texts survive incompletely.

- ☐ **Augustine — The City of God:** A theological and philosophical work composed by Augustine of Hippo in the early 5th century AD, following the sack of Rome by the Visigoths in 410. It contrasts the "earthly city," organized around self-interest, with the "City of God," organized around love of God, and addresses the relationship between Christianity and Roman history. It spans twenty-two books.
- ☐ **Justinian — The Institutes (Corpus Juris Civilis):** A legal textbook compiled under the Byzantine emperor Justinian I and issued in 533 AD, part of the larger Corpus Juris Civilis codification of Roman law. It was intended as an introductory manual for law students. Rediscovered and studied intensively in medieval Europe, it became a basis for civil law systems in much of continental Europe.
- ☐ **John of Salisbury — Policraticus:** A 12th-century treatise by an English scholar and bishop, presenting the state as a body politic with the ruler as its head. It discusses the duties of rulers and officials and includes a discussion of the conditions under which resistance to a tyrannical ruler may be justified. It is among the earliest medieval works of systematic political theory.
- ☐ **Marsilius of Padua — Defensor Pacis:** A political treatise written in 1324 arguing that legitimate political authority derives from the people rather than from ecclesiastical office, and that the Church should not hold coercive temporal power. It was condemned by Pope John XXII shortly after its circulation. Historians frequently cite it as an early statement of ideas associated with popular sovereignty.
- ☐ **Thomas More — Utopia:** A work of fiction published in 1516 by the English lawyer and statesman Thomas More, describing an imaginary island society organized around common property and rational social arrangements. Written partly in the tradition of satire, it contrasts this fictional society with contemporary European conditions. The term "utopia," coined for the book, combines Greek words meaning "no place."
- ☐ **Jean Bodin — Six Books of the Commonwealth:** A political treatise published in 1576 by the French jurist Jean Bodin, written during the French Wars of Religion. It develops the concept of sovereignty as the supreme, indivisible authority within a state. The work influenced later theories of the modern nation-state.
- ☐ **Hugo Grotius — On the Law of War and Peace:** A legal and philosophical treatise published in 1625 by the Dutch jurist Hugo Grotius. It argues for a natural law governing relations between states, including standards for the conduct of war, applicable independently of any single nation's laws. The work is regarded as a foundational text of international law.
- ☐ **Montesquieu — The Spirit of the Laws:** A comparative study of political and legal systems published in 1748 by the French philosopher Montesquieu, examining how climate, custom, and history shape a society's laws and government. It develops the theory of the separation of governmental powers into legislative, executive, and judicial branches. This doctrine influenced the drafting of the United States Constitution.
- ☐ **Hermes Trismegistus — The Corpus Hermeticum; The Emerald Tablet; Asclepius:** A body of Greek and Latin texts attributed to the legendary figure Hermes Trismegistus, likely composed by various authors in Egypt between the 1st and 3rd centuries CE. They address topics including the nature of God, the cosmos, and the human mind, and include the phrase "as above, so below." They were long believed to record ancient Egyptian wisdom and influenced Renaissance philosophy after their rediscovery and translation in the 15th century.
- ☐ **The Chaldean Oracles:** A collection of fragmentary verse attributed to 2nd-century figures Julian the Chaldean and Julian the Theurgist, surviving only through quotations in later Neoplatonist writings. The fragments describe cosmological and ritual teachings associated with theurgy, a practice aimed at union with the divine. They were studied by later Neoplatonist philosophers including Proclus.

- □ **The Orphic Hymns:** A collection of eighty-seven short hymns to various deities, attributed to the mythical poet Orpheus and likely composed in the 2nd or 3rd century CE, possibly for use in ritual contexts. They are associated with Orphism, a set of religious beliefs and practices in ancient Greece concerning the soul and the afterlife. They survive as part of a broader corpus of Orphic literature.
- □ **Iamblichus — On the Mysteries:** A treatise by the Neoplatonist philosopher Iamblichus, written in the early 4th century CE, defending theurgy — ritual practice aimed at communion with the divine — as necessary alongside philosophical contemplation. It responds to a letter attributed to Porphyry questioning such practices. It is a primary source for the study of late antique theurgic ritual.
- □ **Proclus — The Elements of Theology; Platonic Theology:** Works by Proclus, a 5th-century Neoplatonist philosopher who headed the Platonic Academy in Athens. The Elements of Theology presents Neoplatonist metaphysics in a series of logically ordered propositions describing reality as emanating from and returning to a single first principle, the One. His systematic approach influenced later Christian, Islamic, and Jewish philosophical and mystical thought.
- □ **Porphyry — On the Cave of the Nymphs; Letter to Anebo:** Works by Porphyry, a 3rd-century Neoplatonist philosopher and student of Plotinus. On the Cave of the Nymphs offers an allegorical reading of a passage in Homer's Odyssey concerning the soul's descent into the material world. The Letter to Anebo raises critical questions about Egyptian ritual and theurgic practice, prompting Iamblichus's response in On the Mysteries.
- □ **The Nag Hammadi Library — incl. The Gospel of Thomas; Pistis Sophia:** A collection of Gnostic and related texts discovered near Nag Hammadi, Egypt, in 1945, dating from roughly the 2nd to 4th centuries CE. The texts include the Gospel of Thomas, a collection of sayings attributed to Jesus, and Pistis Sophia, a later Gnostic treatise. They reflect a range of early Christian and Gnostic teachings emphasizing salvation through esoteric knowledge (gnosis).
- □ **Zosimos of Panopolis — On the Apparatus and Furnaces:** Writings by Zosimos of Panopolis, a Greco-Egyptian alchemist active around 300 CE, among the earliest known alchemical authors. His texts combine descriptions of chemical apparatus and processes with visionary and allegorical material relating transmutation to spiritual transformation. His work is a primary source for the early history of alchemy.
- □ **Sefer Yetzirah (The Book of Formation):** An early Jewish mystical text of uncertain date, variously placed between the 2nd and 6th centuries CE, describing the creation of the world through combinations of the ten sefirot and the twenty-two letters of the Hebrew alphabet. It is among the earliest texts associated with the Kabbalistic tradition. It has been the subject of extensive later commentary. (Cross-listed in Book 18.)
- □ **The Zohar (The Book of Splendor):** The central text of Kabbalah, a mystical commentary on the Torah written primarily in Aramaic, largely attributed to the 13th-century Spanish writer Moses de León though presented as the teaching of the 2nd-century sage Shimon bar Yochai. It discusses the sefirot, divine emanations through which the infinite (Ein Sof) relates to creation, and the mystical significance of scripture. It has been foundational to later Kabbalistic thought. (Cross-listed in Book 18.)
- □ **The Picatrix (Ghayat al-Hakim):** A treatise on astral magic and talismans, originally composed in Arabic, likely in the 10th or 11th century, and later translated into Latin as the Picatrix. It describes methods for drawing on planetary influences through talismans, ritual, and astrology. It was influential in the transmission of Arabic magical and astrological texts to medieval and Renaissance Europe.
- □ **Marsilio Ficino — Three Books on Life; the Hermetica translations:** Works by Marsilio Ficino, a 15th-century Florentine philosopher who translated Plato's dialogues and the Corpus Hermeticum into Latin. Three Books on Life addresses the health of scholars, combining medical, astrological, and magical recommendations. Ficino's translations were central to the revival of Platonic and Hermetic philosophy in Renaissance Italy.

- ☐ **Heinrich Cornelius Agrippa — Three Books of Occult Philosophy:** A systematic treatise on magic by the German scholar Heinrich Cornelius Agrippa, published in 1533. It organizes magical practice into three domains — natural, celestial, and ceremonial — drawing on classical, Hermetic, and Kabbalistic sources. It became one of the most widely referenced texts of Renaissance occult philosophy.
- ☐ **Paracelsus — Selected Writings:** Writings of Paracelsus, a 16th-century Swiss physician and alchemist who challenged the prevailing Galenic medical tradition in favor of chemical treatment and direct observation. He developed the concept of the human body as a microcosm corresponding to the wider natural world. His work influenced the development of both toxicology and iatrochemistry, the application of chemistry to medicine.
- ☐ **Giordano Bruno — On the Infinite Universe and Worlds; The Ash Wednesday Supper:** Works by Giordano Bruno, a 16th-century Italian philosopher and former Dominican friar, published in 1584. He argued for an infinite universe containing innumerable worlds, drawing on Copernican astronomy and Hermetic philosophy. Bruno was tried by the Roman Inquisition and executed in 1600.
- ☐ **Robert Fludd — Utriusque Cosmi Historia:** An illustrated treatise by the English physician and Rosicrucian sympathizer Robert Fludd, published in the 1610s-1620s, presenting a detailed correspondence between the macrocosm (the universe) and the microcosm (the human being). It draws on Hermetic, alchemical, and musical theory. Its engraved diagrams are frequently reproduced as examples of early modern esoteric illustration.
- ☐ **The Rosicrucian Manifestos (Fama Fraternitatis; Confessio Fraternitatis):** Anonymous pamphlets published in Germany in 1614 and 1615, announcing the existence of a secret brotherhood dedicated to spiritual and intellectual reform, associated with the legendary figure Christian Rosenkreuz. Their publication generated widespread discussion across early 17th-century Europe. No organized Rosicrucian brotherhood has been historically confirmed to have existed prior to the manifestos.
- ☐ **The Key of Solomon (Clavicula Salomonis):** A grimoire, or magical text, of uncertain authorship, circulating in various manuscript versions from the medieval and Renaissance periods, traditionally attributed to King Solomon. It contains instructions, seals, and rituals for invoking and commanding spirits. It is among the most widely copied Western ceremonial magic texts.
- ☐ **Jakob Bohme — Aurora; The Signature of All Things:** Works by Jakob Böhme, a German shoemaker and mystic writing in the early 17th century. Aurora, his first work, describes a theological vision of God's self-revelation through the interplay of opposing forces. His writings influenced later German idealist philosophy and Christian mystical traditions, including Romanticism.
- ☐ **Emanuel Swedenborg — Heaven and Hell:** A 1758 work by the Swedish scientist and theologian Emanuel Swedenborg, describing his accounts of the afterlife based on visionary experiences he reported having from the 1740s onward. It presents a doctrine of "correspondences" linking the natural and spiritual worlds. His writings influenced later figures including William Blake and the Swedenborgian church movement.

Module 12: The Modern Mind

About 20.5 hours of reading and 0.4 hours of survey.

From the Enlightenment to the twentieth century: the limits of reason, revolution and its critics, history, the death of God, evolution, and the unconscious. The Forbidden Shelf is surveyed here too, as a record of the tradition's most radical critics.

What to take away

- Hume doubts causation and the self. Kant answers that the mind structures experience, and grounds morality in duty.
- Hegel and Marx read history as a development driven by conflict. Burke and Tocqueville warn about what revolutions and democracy can destroy.
- Kierkegaard, Nietzsche, and Freud move the question of meaning into the individual, the will, and the unconscious.

Read

1. ☐ **David Hume — A Treatise of Human Nature; Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding** (~2 h)

Read: Enquiry Concerning Human Understanding, sections II-VII.

Edition: Enquiry ed. Tom Beauchamp (Oxford); Treatise ed. Norton and Norton (Oxford)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

2. ☐ **Jean-Jacques Rousseau — The Social Contract; Emile; Confessions** (~2 h)

Read: The Social Contract, Book I.

Edition: The Social Contract and Other Later Political Writings, ed. Victor Gourevitch (Cambridge); Emile tr. Allan Bloom (Basic Books)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

3. ☐ **Immanuel Kant — Critique of Pure Reason; of Practical Reason; of Judgment; Groundwork** (~3 h)

Read: Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals, Sections I-II.

Edition: Groundwork tr. Mary Gregor (Cambridge); Critique of Pure Reason tr. Guyer and Wood (Cambridge) or Werner Pluhar (Hackett)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

4. ☐ **Edmund Burke — Reflections on the Revolution in France** (~1 h)

Read: Selections, including the passage on society as a partnership of the dead, the living, and the unborn.

Edition: Ed. J.G.A. Pocock (Hackett); or L.G. Mitchell (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

5. ☐ **Alexis de Tocqueville — Democracy in America** (~1 h)

Read: Vol. I Part II ch. 7 (tyranny of the majority) and Vol. II Part IV ch. 6 (soft despotism).

Edition: Tr. Harvey Mansfield and Delba Winthrop (Chicago)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

6. ☐ **Georg Wilhelm Friedrich Hegel — The Phenomenology of Spirit; Science of Logic; Philosophy of Right (~1 h)**
 Read: Phenomenology of Spirit, paras. 178-196 (lordship and bondage), with a guide.
 Edition: Phenomenology tr. A.V. Miller (Oxford), paragraph numbers as cited; Philosophy of Right ed. Allen Wood (Cambridge)
 Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
7. ☐ **Søren Kierkegaard — Fear and Trembling; Either/Or; The Sickness Unto Death (~1.5 h)**
 Read: Fear and Trembling: the Exordium and Problema I.
 Edition: Tr. Alastair Hannay, Fear and Trembling (Penguin); or Hong and Hong (Princeton)
 Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
8. ☐ **Karl Marx — Capital; Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts (~1.5 h)**
 Read: 'Estranged Labour' from the 1844 Manuscripts.
 Edition: The Marx-Engels Reader, ed. Robert Tucker (Norton); Capital vol. 1 tr. Ben Fowkes (Penguin)
 Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
9. ☐ **Charles Darwin — On the Origin of Species; The Voyage of the Beagle (~2 h)**
 Read: On the Origin of Species, chapters 3-4 and the final paragraph.
 Edition: On the Origin of Species, 1st edition (1859), Penguin Classics or Oxford World's Classics
 Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
10. ☐ **Friedrich Nietzsche — The Birth of Tragedy; On the Genealogy of Morals; The Gay Science (~2 h)**
 Read: On the Genealogy of Morals, First Essay; The Gay Science 125 (the madman).
 Edition: Basic Writings of Nietzsche, tr. Walter Kaufmann (Modern Library); The Gay Science tr. Kaufmann (Vintage)
 Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
11. ☐ **Sigmund Freud — The Interpretation of Dreams; Civilization and Its Discontents (~1.5 h)**
 Read: Civilization and Its Discontents, chapters 1-3.
 Edition: Standard Edition, tr. James Strachey: Civilization and Its Discontents (Norton); The Interpretation of Dreams (Basic Books)
 Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
12. ☐ **Ludwig Wittgenstein — Tractatus Logico-Philosophicus; Philosophical Investigations (~1 h)**
 Read: Tractatus 1-2.063 and 6.4-7.
 Edition: Tractatus tr. Pears and McGuinness (Routledge); Philosophical Investigations tr. Anscombe, Hacker and Schulte (Wiley-Blackwell)
 Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)
13. ☐ **Simone Weil — Gravity and Grace; Waiting for God (~1 h)**
 Read: A selection from Gravity and Grace.
 Edition: Gravity and Grace, tr. Emma Crawford and Mario von der Ruhr (Routledge Classics)
 Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

Check yourself. Nietzsche's madman announces the death of God. Name three thinkers in this module and how each responds, directly or not.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Francis Bacon — Novum Organum; Essays:** Works by the English philosopher and statesman Francis Bacon. The *Novum Organum* (1620) proposes a method of scientific inquiry based on systematic observation and induction, and describes cognitive biases he termed "idols of the mind." Bacon is regarded as an early and influential advocate of the empirical scientific method.
- ☐ **Baruch Spinoza — Ethics:** A philosophical work by Baruch Spinoza, published posthumously in 1677, structured in the style of geometric proofs with definitions, axioms, and propositions. It presents a metaphysical system in which God and Nature are identified as a single substance, and discusses ethics, the emotions, and human freedom. Spinoza had been excommunicated from the Amsterdam Jewish community in 1656.
- ☐ **Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz — Monadology:** A short philosophical text written by Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz in 1714, outlining a metaphysical system based on indivisible, non-interacting units called monads, coordinated through what he termed pre-established harmony. It includes his argument that the actual world is the best of all possible worlds. The claim was later satirized by Voltaire in *Candide*.
- ☐ **George Berkeley — Principles of Human Knowledge:** A 1710 work by the Irish philosopher and bishop George Berkeley, presenting the idealist position that material objects exist only as they are perceived (summarized in the phrase "esse est percipi," to be is to be perceived). Berkeley argued that the continued existence of unperceived objects depends on their being perceived by God. It is a foundational text of subjective idealism.
- ☐ **Johann Gottlieb Fichte — The Science of Knowledge:** A philosophical work by Johann Gottlieb Fichte, first published in 1794, developing a system of transcendental idealism building on Kant's philosophy. Fichte grounds his system in an active, self-positing "I" that constitutes both itself and its experience of the world. He was an early figure in German Idealism.
- ☐ **Friedrich Schelling — System of Transcendental Idealism:** An 1800 work by the German philosopher Friedrich Wilhelm Joseph Schelling, part of the German Idealist tradition. It discusses the relationship between nature and self-consciousness and gives particular attention to the role of art as a point where conscious and unconscious activity converge. Schelling's philosophy of nature influenced German Romantic thought.
- ☐ **Arthur Schopenhauer — The World as Will and Representation; Essays and Aphorisms:** The principal philosophical work of Arthur Schopenhauer, first published in 1818, presenting a metaphysical system centered on an underlying, striving force he called Will, which manifests in all phenomena and drives a cycle of desire and suffering. He proposed aesthetic contemplation, compassion, and ascetic renunciation of desire as means of relief. His philosophy drew on Indian philosophical texts and influenced later thinkers including Nietzsche and Wagner.
- ☐ **Henri Bergson — Creative Evolution:** A 1907 work by the French philosopher Henri Bergson, which distinguishes lived, qualitative time (duration) from the quantitative time measured by clocks. It presents evolution as driven by a creative impulse he called the *élan vital*. Bergson received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1927.
- ☐ **William James — The Principles of Psychology; The Varieties of Religious Experience:** Works by the American philosopher and psychologist William James, published in 1890 and 1902. *The Principles of Psychology* is a foundational text of the discipline; *The Varieties of Religious Experience* examines religious experience as a subject of psychological study, based on his 1901-02 Gifford Lectures. James is closely associated with the philosophical school of pragmatism.
- ☐ **Edmund Husserl — Cartesian Meditations:** A work by the German philosopher Edmund Husserl, based on lectures delivered in 1929, presenting an introduction to his method of phenomenology. It describes the practice of bracketing (*epoché*) assumptions about the external world in order to examine the structures of consciousness directly. Husserl is regarded as the founder of phenomenology as a philosophical method.

- ☐ **Martin Heidegger — Being and Time:** A 1927 work by the German philosopher Martin Heidegger examining the question of the meaning of Being. It introduces concepts including "thrownness," everyday inauthentic existence, and being-toward-death as constitutive of human existence (Dasein). Heidegger's later involvement with the Nazi party has been the subject of significant scholarly discussion and controversy.
- ☐ **Jean-Paul Sartre — Being and Nothingness:** A 1943 philosophical work by the French philosopher Jean-Paul Sartre, a major text of existentialist philosophy. It argues that existence precedes essence, meaning humans are not born with a fixed nature but define themselves through their choices, and discusses the concept of "bad faith" as self-deception about one's freedom. Sartre also addresses the human search for meaning without recourse to essentialist or theistic frameworks.
- ☐ **Carl Gustav Jung — The Archetypes and the Collective Unconscious; Aion; Answer to Job; Memories, Dreams, Reflections:** Works by the Swiss psychiatrist Carl Gustav Jung, a former collaborator of Freud who developed his own school of analytical psychology. He proposed the existence of a collective unconscious containing universal archetypes shared across cultures, and described individuation as the psychological process of integrating conscious and unconscious aspects of the self. His later work drew on comparative mythology, religion, and alchemical symbolism.
- ☐ **Alfred Adler — Understanding Human Nature:** A 1927 work by the Austrian psychiatrist Alfred Adler, another early associate of Freud who developed the school of individual psychology. It presents his theory that personality development centers on overcoming feelings of inferiority and seeking social belonging, introducing the concept of the "inferiority complex." Adler emphasized social interest and practical engagement as markers of psychological health.
- ☐ **Giambattista Vico — The New Science:** A work by the Italian philosopher Giambattista Vico, first published in 1725 with revised editions following. It proposes a cyclical theory of history in which societies pass through recurring ages of gods, heroes, and men, and argues that human beings can have genuine knowledge of history because they created it. Vico's work is regarded as an early contribution to the philosophy of history and social science.
- ☐ **Voltaire — Candide; Philosophical Dictionary:** Works by the French Enlightenment writer Voltaire. *Candide* (1759) is a satirical novella following its protagonist through a series of disasters, mocking the philosophical optimism associated with Leibniz, and concludes with the line "we must cultivate our garden." The *Philosophical Dictionary* (1764) is a collection of essays on religious, political, and philosophical topics.
- ☐ **Adam Smith — The Theory of Moral Sentiments; The Wealth of Nations:** Works by the Scottish philosopher and economist Adam Smith, published in 1759 and 1776. *The Theory of Moral Sentiments* develops an account of ethics grounded in sympathy and the impartial spectator; *The Wealth of Nations* analyzes market economies, the division of labor, and introduces the concept of the "invisible hand" by which individual self-interest can contribute to broader economic outcomes. Smith is widely regarded as a founding figure of modern economics.
- ☐ **Hannah Arendt — The Human Condition; The Origins of Totalitarianism:** Works by the German-American political theorist Hannah Arendt, published in 1958 and 1951. *The Origins of Totalitarianism* analyzes the political and social conditions that gave rise to Nazi and Stalinist regimes; *The Human Condition* examines categories of human activity, including labor, work, and action, and their significance for political life. Arendt later wrote about the trial of Adolf Eichmann, coining the phrase "the banality of evil."

- ☐ **Julius Evola — *Revolt Against the Modern World; Ride the Tiger; Men Among the Ruins*:** Julius Evola (1898-1974) was an Italian philosopher associated with the Traditionalist School. *Revolt Against the Modern World* (1934) sets out a view of history as decline from earlier hierarchical, sacred social orders; *Ride the Tiger* (1961) advises how an individual might live within what Evola considered a late, dissolving phase of history. *Men Among the Ruins* (1953) applies these ideas to postwar politics; Evola's work has been associated with fascist and radical-right political movements.
- ☐ **Carl Schmitt — *The Concept of the Political; Political Theology*:** Carl Schmitt (1888-1985) was a German jurist and political theorist. *The Concept of the Political* (1932) defines politics around the distinction between friend and enemy; *Political Theology* (1922) argues that modern political concepts derive from theological ones and defines sovereignty in terms of the power to decide on a state of exception. Schmitt was a member of the Nazi Party and held academic and legal positions in Germany during the early years of Nazi rule.
- ☐ **Oswald Spengler — *The Decline of the West*:** Oswald Spengler (1880-1936) was a German historian and philosopher. *The Decline of the West*, published in two volumes (1918 and 1922), presents a comparative theory of history in which distinct cultures pass through analogous stages of growth and decline, likened to biological life cycles. The book argues that Western civilization had entered a late, "civilizational" phase.
- ☐ **Georges Sorel — *Reflections on Violence*:** Georges Sorel (1847-1922) was a French philosopher and social theorist. *Reflections on Violence* (1908) discusses the political function of the "myth" of the revolutionary general strike and argues for the mobilizing role of collective action in working-class movements. Sorel's ideas influenced strands of both revolutionary syndicalism and, later, fascist political thought.
- ☐ **Joseph de Maistre — *St. Petersburg Dialogues; Considerations on France*:** Joseph de Maistre (1753-1821) was a Savoyard political philosopher and diplomat. *Considerations on France* (1797) interprets the French Revolution as a providential punishment and argues against Enlightenment rationalism; the *St. Petersburg Dialogues*, published posthumously in 1821, present his defense of monarchy, religious authority, and traditional social hierarchy. He is generally regarded as a leading voice of European counter-revolutionary thought.
- ☐ **Max Stirner — *The Ego and Its Own*:** Max Stirner (Johann Kaspar Schmidt, 1806-1856) was a German philosopher. *The Ego and Its Own* (1844) argues against the authority of abstract concepts such as God, the state, and morality, which Stirner terms "spooks," in favor of the interests of the concrete individual. The book is frequently discussed in relation to the development of individualist anarchism.
- ☐ **E.M. Cioran — *A Short History of Decay; The Trouble with Being Born*:** Emil Cioran (1911-1995) was a Romanian-born philosopher who wrote primarily in French after emigrating to Paris. *A Short History of Decay* (1949) and *The Trouble with Being Born* (1973) are collections of aphorisms and short essays addressing pessimism and the value of existence. Cioran's earlier writing in Romania during the 1930s included essays sympathetic to fascist politics, a period he later distanced himself from.
- ☐ **Marquis de Sade — *Philosophy in the Bedroom*:** The Marquis de Sade (Donatien Alphonse Francois de Sade, 1740-1814) was a French writer and philosopher. *Philosophy in the Bedroom* (1795) is structured as a series of dialogues combining explicit sexual content with philosophical argument, including material presenting materialist and libertine ethical positions. Sade was imprisoned for much of his life on charges related to his conduct and writings; the term "sadism" derives from his name.

Module 13: The Modern Imagination

About 19 hours of reading and 0.8 hours of survey.

The novel, the lyric, and the drama of the last three centuries, read as answers to everything before them. Most readings are complete shorter works or pivotal chapters of long ones.

What to take away

- Goethe and the Romantics make striving, nature, and feeling into sources of meaning.
- The Russian novelists test modern ideas against faith, suffering, and death: the Underground Man, the Grand Inquisitor, Ivan Ilyich.
- The modernists (Kafka, Conrad, Eliot, Camus) write about alienation, the absurd, and the search for order among fragments.

Read

1. ☐ **Johann Wolfgang von Goethe — Faust; The Sorrows of Young Werther** (~2 h)

Read: Faust Part One, from the opening through the pact with Mephistopheles.

Edition: Faust tr. Walter Arndt (Norton Critical Edition) or David Luke (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

2. ☐ **William Blake — Songs of Innocence and of Experience; The Marriage of Heaven and Hell** (~0.5 h)

Read: 'The Lamb' and 'The Tyger'.

Edition: Blake's Poetry and Designs (Norton Critical Edition); the William Blake Archive online shows the illuminated plates

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

3. ☐ **William Wordsworth — The Prelude; Lyrical Ballads** (~0.5 h)

Read: 'Tintern Abbey'.

Edition: Wordsworth's Poetry and Prose (Norton Critical Edition); The Prelude 1799, 1805, 1850 (Norton)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

4. ☐ **Leo Tolstoy — War and Peace; Anna Karenina; The Death of Ivan Ilyich** (~2 h)

Read: The Death of Ivan Ilyich, in full.

Edition: Tr. Richard Pevear and Larissa Volokhonsky (Vintage), or Louise and Aylmer Maude (Oxford World's Classics)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

5. ☐ **Dostoevsky — Crime and Punishment; The Brothers Karamazov; Demons; The Idiot; Notes from Underground** (~4 h)

Read: Notes from Underground Part I; The Brothers Karamazov Book V, chapters 4-5 ('Rebellion' and 'The Grand Inquisitor').

Edition: Tr. Richard Pevear and Larissa Volokhonsky (Vintage)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

6. ☐ **Herman Melville — Moby-Dick** (~1.5 h)

Read: Chapters 1, 36 ('The Quarter-Deck'), 42 ('The Whiteness of the Whale'), and 135.

Edition: Norton Critical Edition or Penguin Classics

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

7. ☐ **Kafka — The Trial; The Castle; The Metamorphosis; Diaries** (~2 h)

Read: The Metamorphosis.

Edition: The Metamorphosis tr. Susan Bernofsky (Norton); The Trial tr. Breon Mitchell (Schocken)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

8. ☐ **Anton Chekhov — Selected Stories and Plays** (~1 h)

Read: 'The Lady with the Dog'.

Edition: Stories tr. Pevear and Volokhonsky (Bantam); plays tr. Paul Schmidt (Harper)

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

9. ☐ **Joseph Conrad — Heart of Darkness; Lord Jim** (~2.5 h)

Read: Heart of Darkness, in full.

Edition: Norton Critical Edition or Penguin Classics

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

10. ☐ **T.S. Eliot — The Waste Land; Four Quartets** (~1 h)

Read: The Waste Land, with its notes.

Edition: Collected Poems 1909-1962 (Faber / Harcourt); The Waste Land Norton Critical Edition

Find it: [Free public-domain text \(Gutenberg search\)](#) · [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

11. ☐ **Albert Camus — The Stranger; The Myth of Sisyphus** (~2 h)

Read: The title essay of The Myth of Sisyphus; The Stranger Part I.

Edition: The Stranger tr. Matthew Ward (Vintage); The Myth of Sisyphus tr. Justin O'Brien (Vintage)

Find it: [Open Library](#) · [Internet Archive](#) · [Project Gutenberg](#)

Check yourself. Choose one work from this module and trace three of its sources back through earlier modules.

Survey

Read each description. That is enough to know what the work is and where it belongs.

- ☐ **Mishima — The Sea of Fertility; Confessions of a Mask; Sun and Steel; Patriotism:** Yukio Mishima (1925-1970) was a Japanese novelist and essayist. The Sea of Fertility is a four-novel cycle following reincarnation across twentieth-century Japan; Confessions of a Mask is a semi-autobiographical novel about a young man's concealed identity. Sun and Steel is a memoir-essay on bodybuilding and physical discipline, and Patriotism is a short story about a military officer's ritual suicide; Mishima died by seppuku in 1970 after a failed coup attempt.
- ☐ **Tolkien — The Lord of the Rings; The Silmarillion; The Hobbit:** J.R.R. Tolkien (1892-1973) was an English writer and philologist. The Hobbit (1937) and The Lord of the Rings (1954-55) are fantasy novels set in Middle-earth, following a quest to destroy a powerful ring. The Silmarillion, published posthumously in 1977, compiles the mythology and history underlying the earlier books; Tolkien, a Catholic, incorporated themes of providence and moral choice into the narrative.
- ☐ **Friedrich Nietzsche — Thus Spoke Zarathustra; Beyond Good and Evil:** Friedrich Nietzsche (1844-1900) was a German philosopher. Thus Spoke Zarathustra (1883-85) is written in a poetic, prophetic style and introduces concepts including the "übermensch" and eternal recurrence through the figure of Zarathustra. Beyond Good and Evil (1886) is a more discursive philosophical work critiquing prior moral and metaphysical systems.

- ☐ **Knut Hamsun — Hunger; Growth of the Soil:** Knut Hamsun (1859-1952) was a Norwegian novelist. *Hunger* (1890) is a first-person narrative depicting a starving writer's deteriorating mental state in Christiania (Oslo); *Growth of the Soil* (1917), for which Hamsun received the Nobel Prize in Literature, follows a settler establishing a farm in rural Norway. Hamsun's later support for Nazi Germany during World War II remains a subject of biographical discussion.
- ☐ **Louis-Ferdinand Celine — Journey to the End of the Night:** Louis-Ferdinand Celine (1894-1961) was a French novelist. *Journey to the End of the Night* (1932) follows its narrator through World War I, colonial Africa, the United States, and postwar France, written in a colloquial, slang-inflected style. Celine's later writings included antisemitic pamphlets, a fact widely discussed alongside his literary work.
- ☐ **Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn — The Gulag Archipelago; One Day in the Life of Ivan Denisovich:** Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn (1918-2008) was a Russian writer who was imprisoned in the Soviet labor camp system. *The Gulag Archipelago* (1973) is a multi-volume documentary and literary account of that system, based on his own experience and testimony he gathered from other former prisoners. *One Day in the Life of Ivan Denisovich* (1962) is a novella depicting a single day in a labor camp.
- ☐ **Ernst Junger — Storm of Steel; On the Marble Cliffs:** Ernst Junger (1895-1998) was a German writer and World War I veteran. *Storm of Steel* (1920) is a memoir based on his diaries from service on the Western Front. *On the Marble Cliffs* (1939) is an allegorical novel, written under Nazi rule, that has been read as a veiled critique of totalitarian violence.
- ☐ **Hermann Hesse — Siddhartha; The Glass Bead Game:** Hermann Hesse (1877-1962) was a German-Swiss writer. *Siddhartha* (1922) follows a man in ancient India across various stages of spiritual searching, including asceticism, worldly life, and eventual settlement by a river. *The Glass Bead Game* (1943), his final novel, is set in a future intellectual order centered on an abstract synthesis of the arts and sciences.
- ☐ **Georges Bernanos — The Diary of a Country Priest:** Georges Bernanos (1888-1948) was a French Catholic novelist. *The Diary of a Country Priest* (1936) is written as the journal of a young, physically ill priest serving an unwelcoming rural parish in northern France. The novel addresses themes of vocation, suffering, and grace.
- ☐ **Evelyn Waugh — Brideshead Revisited:** Evelyn Waugh (1903-1966) was an English novelist. *Brideshead Revisited* (1945) follows the narrator Charles Ryder's relationship, over roughly two decades, with the aristocratic and Catholic Flyte family. The novel addresses memory, class, and religious belief in early-to-mid twentieth-century England.
- ☐ **G.K. Chesterton — Orthodoxy; The Everlasting Man:** G.K. Chesterton (1874-1936) was an English writer. *Orthodoxy* (1908) is an autobiographical and apologetic essay describing his path to Christian belief. *The Everlasting Man* (1925) is a work of Christian apologetics addressing human prehistory and history, written partly in response to H.G. Wells's *Outline of History*.
- ☐ **C.S. Lewis — The Abolition of Man; Till We Have Faces:** C.S. Lewis (1898-1963) was a British writer and academic. *The Abolition of Man* (1943) is a series of lectures arguing against moral subjectivism and for an objective natural law he termed the Tao. *Till We Have Faces* (1956) is a novel retelling the myth of Cupid and Psyche from the perspective of Psyche's sister.
- ☐ **Rainer Maria Rilke — Duino Elegies:** Rainer Maria Rilke (1875-1926) was a German-language poet. The *Duino Elegies*, ten poems begun in 1912 and completed in 1922, address themes including mortality, transience, and the relationship between human beings and the more enduring order of angels. The sequence is named for Duino Castle, near Trieste, where Rilke began the first elegy.

- ☐ **Stendhal — The Red and the Black:** Stendhal (Marie-Henri Beyle, 1783-1842) was a French novelist. The Red and the Black (1830) follows Julien Sorel, a carpenter's son who advances through French society via the church and the aristocracy in the years following the Napoleonic era. The novel is known for its use of psychological interiority.
- ☐ **Honore de Balzac — Pere Goriot; Lost Illusions:** Honore de Balzac (1799-1850) was a French novelist whose works were collected under the title The Human Comedy, a project intended to depict French society comprehensively after the Revolution. Pere Goriot (1835) follows an elderly man impoverished by his devotion to his two daughters; Lost Illusions (1837-43) follows a young provincial poet's entry into Parisian literary and journalistic life.
- ☐ **Gustave Flaubert — Madame Bovary; Sentimental Education:** Gustave Flaubert (1821-1880) was a French novelist known for his attention to precise prose style. Madame Bovary (1856) follows a provincial doctor's wife whose romantic expectations, shaped by novels she has read, lead to affairs and financial ruin. Sentimental Education (1869) follows a young man's ambitions and disappointments in Paris around the 1848 revolution.
- ☐ **Victor Hugo — Les Miserables; The Hunchback of Notre-Dame:** Victor Hugo (1802-1885) was a French novelist and poet. Les Miserables (1862) follows Jean Valjean, a former convict, across several decades of nineteenth-century France, addressing poverty, law, and redemption. The Hunchback of Notre-Dame (1831) is set in fifteenth-century Paris and centers on the bell-ringer Quasimodo and the cathedral of Notre-Dame.
- ☐ **Aleksandr Pushkin — Eugene Onegin:** Alexander Pushkin (1799-1837) was a Russian poet, regarded as a founder of modern Russian literature. Eugene Onegin, a novel written in verse and published serially between 1825 and 1832, follows a disaffected aristocrat who rejects a young woman's declaration of love and later regrets it. It is written in a fixed stanza form now known as the Onegin stanza.
- ☐ **Nikolai Gogol — Dead Souls; The Overcoat:** Nikolai Gogol (1809-1852) was a Russian writer of Ukrainian origin. Dead Souls (1842) follows a con man who travels the Russian provinces buying the legal titles to deceased serfs; The Overcoat (1842) is a short story about a poor clerk who saves for a new coat, only to have it stolen. Both works are noted for their satirical treatment of Russian bureaucracy.
- ☐ **Marcel Proust — In Search of Lost Time:** Marcel Proust (1871-1922) was a French novelist. In Search of Lost Time, published in seven volumes between 1913 and 1927, is a long first-person novel exploring memory, time, and society in late nineteenth- and early twentieth-century France; an early scene involves the narrator's memory being triggered by tasting a madeleine cake dipped in tea.
- ☐ **James Joyce — Ulysses; A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man:** James Joyce (1882-1941) was an Irish writer. Ulysses (1922) follows Leopold Bloom, Molly Bloom, and Stephen Dedalus through a single day in Dublin, June 16, 1904, using stream-of-consciousness narration and loosely paralleling Homer's Odyssey. A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916) is an earlier, more conventionally structured novel about Stephen Dedalus's youth.
- ☐ **Thomas Mann — The Magic Mountain; Death in Venice; Doctor Faustus:** Thomas Mann (1875-1955) was a German novelist. The Magic Mountain (1924) is set in a Swiss tuberculosis sanatorium in the years before World War I and includes extended philosophical discussions among its characters; Death in Venice (1912) is a novella about an aging writer's fascination with a young boy while in Venice. Doctor Faustus (1947) reworks the Faust legend through the life of a composer in early twentieth-century Germany.
- ☐ **William Faulkner — The Sound and the Fury; Absalom, Absalom!:** William Faulkner (1897-1962) was an American novelist. The Sound and the Fury (1929) and Absalom, Absalom! (1936) are set in the fictional Yoknapatawpha County, Mississippi, and use non-linear narration and multiple narrators to depict the decline of Southern families across generations. Faulkner received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1949.

- ☐ **Moliere — The Misanthrope; Tartuffe:** Moliere (Jean-Baptiste Poquelin, 1622-1673) was a French playwright and actor. *Tartuffe* (1664) concerns a household deceived by a religious hypocrite who ingratiate himself with its head; *The Misanthrope* (1666) follows a man who rejects the social conventions and flattery of his circle. Both are verse comedies addressing hypocrisy and manners in seventeenth-century French society.
- ☐ **Jean Racine — Phedre; Andromache:** Jean Racine (1639-1699) was a French playwright associated with classical tragedy. *Phedre* (1677) dramatizes the story of Phaedra's forbidden love for her stepson Hippolytus, drawn from Greek mythology via Euripides and Seneca; *Andromache* (1667) follows the widow of Hector after the fall of Troy. Both plays follow the conventions of French neoclassical drama, including the unities of time, place, and action.
- ☐ **Charles Baudelaire — Les Fleurs du Mal:** Charles Baudelaire (1821-1867) was a French poet. *Les Fleurs du Mal* (The Flowers of Evil), first published in 1857, is a collection of poems addressing urban life, beauty, sin, and mortality; parts of the original edition were prosecuted for obscenity under French law. The collection is often cited as an influence on later French Symbolist poetry.
- ☐ **Walt Whitman — Leaves of Grass:** Walt Whitman (1819-1892) was an American poet. *Leaves of Grass*, first published in 1855 and revised across multiple editions through 1892, is a collection of poems written largely in free verse addressing democracy, the body, nature, and American national identity. "Song of Myself" is its best-known individual poem.
- ☐ **Friedrich Holderlin — Hymns and Fragments:** Friedrich Holderlin (1770-1843) was a German poet. His hymns and later fragmentary poems, written between the 1790s and around 1806 when he began to suffer from mental illness, address classical Greek mythology, the divine, and the German landscape. His work received renewed critical attention in the twentieth century, including commentary by the philosopher Martin Heidegger.
- ☐ **Jaroslav Hasek — The Good Soldier Svejk:** Jaroslav Hasek (1883-1923) was a Czech writer. *The Good Soldier Svejk*, published in installments beginning in 1921 and left unfinished at Hasek's death, follows a soldier in the Austro-Hungarian army during World War I whose exaggerated compliance and apparent simple-mindedness disrupt military bureaucracy. It is written in a comic, episodic style and satirizes military and imperial institutions.
- ☐ **Samuel Taylor Coleridge — The Rime of the Ancient Mariner:** Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834) was an English poet and critic. *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*, first published in the 1798 *Lyrical Ballads*, is a narrative ballad about a sailor who kills an albatross and is subsequently cursed, undergoing a period of suffering and eventual partial redemption. It employs archaic language and a supernatural narrative frame.
- ☐ **Lord Byron — Don Juan; Childe Harold's Pilgrimage:** Lord Byron (George Gordon Byron, 1788-1824) was an English poet. *Childe Harold's Pilgrimage* (1812-18) is a narrative poem following a disillusioned young traveler through Europe and popularized the archetype later termed the "Byronic hero." *Don Juan* (1819-24, unfinished) is a lengthy satirical narrative poem in comic verse.
- ☐ **Percy Bysshe Shelley — Prometheus Unbound:** Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792-1822) was an English Romantic poet. *Prometheus Unbound* (1820) is a lyrical drama reworking the Greek myth of Prometheus, in which the title figure is eventually freed and tyranny is overthrown; it reflects Shelley's political radicalism and interest in themes of liberty.
- ☐ **John Keats — The Great Odes; Hyperion:** John Keats (1795-1821) was an English Romantic poet who died of tuberculosis at age twenty-five. His major odes, including "Ode to a Nightingale," "Ode on a Grecian Urn," and "To Autumn," were written in 1819 and address beauty, mortality, and time. *Hyperion* is an unfinished epic poem on the overthrow of the Titans by the Olympian gods.

- ☐ **Alfred, Lord Tennyson — Idylls of the King; In Memoriam:** Alfred, Lord Tennyson (1809-1892) was the British Poet Laureate for much of the Victorian era. *In Memoriam A.H.H.* (1850) is a long elegy written over some seventeen years following the death of his close friend Arthur Hallam. *Idylls of the King* (1859-85) is a cycle of narrative poems retelling the Arthurian legend.
- ☐ **Emily Dickinson — The Complete Poems:** Emily Dickinson (1830-1886) was an American poet who spent most of her life in Amherst, Massachusetts, and published almost none of her roughly 1,800 poems during her lifetime. Her poems, most written in short, irregular stanzas with distinctive punctuation, address subjects including death, nature, and the mind. They were collected and published posthumously, beginning in 1890.
- ☐ **William Butler Yeats — The Tower; Collected Poems:** William Butler Yeats (1865-1939) was an Irish poet and a leading figure in Irish literary and cultural life. His work spans early poems drawing on Irish myth and folklore to later collections, including *The Tower* (1928), addressing aging, Irish politics, and his personal symbolic system. "The Second Coming" (1919) is among his most frequently cited poems; Yeats received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1923.
- ☐ **Fernando Pessoa — The Book of Disquiet; the heteronym poems:** Fernando Pessoa (1888-1935) was a Portuguese writer who composed much of his work under invented authorial personas, or "heteronyms," each with a distinct biography and style. *The Book of Disquiet*, assembled and published posthumously, is a fragmentary prose work presented as the reflections of a Lisbon office worker. Most of Pessoa's writing was published only after his death.
- ☐ **Federico Garcia Lorca — Gypsy Ballads (Romancero Gitano):** Federico Garcia Lorca (1898-1936) was a Spanish poet and playwright from Andalusia. *Gypsy Ballads* (1928) is a collection of narrative poems drawing on Andalusian folk balladry, the Andalusian landscape, and Romani culture. Lorca was killed in 1936 during the early months of the Spanish Civil War.
- ☐ **Pablo Neruda — Canto General:** Pablo Neruda (1904-1973) was a Chilean poet and diplomat. *Canto General* (1950) is a long poem in multiple sections addressing the history, geography, and peoples of Latin America, including a section devoted to the Inca site of Machu Picchu. Neruda received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1971.
- ☐ **Jane Austen — Pride and Prejudice; Emma:** Jane Austen (1775-1817) was an English novelist. *Pride and Prejudice* (1813) follows Elizabeth Bennet and her family amid questions of marriage and social class in early nineteenth-century England; *Emma* (1815) follows a young woman who occupies herself matchmaking among her acquaintances. Both novels are known for their use of free indirect discourse and social comedy of manners.
- ☐ **Charles Dickens — Bleak House; Great Expectations; David Copperfield:** Charles Dickens (1812-1870) was an English novelist whose works were largely published serially. *Bleak House* (1852-53) centers on a protracted Chancery lawsuit and addresses the English legal system; *Great Expectations* (1860-61) and *David Copperfield* (1849-50) are bildungsromans following their protagonists from childhood into adulthood. His novels frequently address poverty and social conditions in Victorian England.
- ☐ **George Eliot — Middlemarch:** George Eliot (Mary Ann Evans, 1819-1880) was an English novelist. *Middlemarch* (1871-72) depicts the interconnected lives of residents in a fictional English provincial town in the early 1830s, including Dorothea Brooke's unhappy marriage and Tertius Lydgate's medical ambitions. The novel is noted for its psychological detail and its treatment of provincial social dynamics.

- ☐ **Henrik Ibsen — A Doll's House; Hedda Gabler; Peer Gynt:** Henrik Ibsen (1828-1906) was a Norwegian playwright. *A Doll's House* (1879) and *Hedda Gabler* (1890) are realist dramas addressing marriage, gender roles, and social convention in bourgeois households; *Peer Gynt* (1867) is an earlier verse drama following a wandering, self-mythologizing protagonist through fantastical episodes. Ibsen is frequently discussed as a significant figure in the development of modern realist theater.
- ☐ **Giuseppe di Lampedusa — The Leopard:** Giuseppe Tomasi di Lampedusa (1896-1957) was an Italian, Sicilian nobleman and writer. *The Leopard*, published posthumously in 1958, follows a Sicilian aristocrat, Don Fabrizio, and his family during and after Garibaldi's unification campaign in 1860s Sicily. The novel addresses the decline of the old Sicilian aristocracy amid political and social change.
- ☐ **Yasunari Kawabata — Snow Country:** Yasunari Kawabata (1899-1972) was a Japanese novelist. *Snow Country*, published in stages between 1935 and 1947, follows a relationship between a Tokyo dilettante and a geisha in a remote hot-spring town in the mountains of western Japan. Kawabata received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1968.